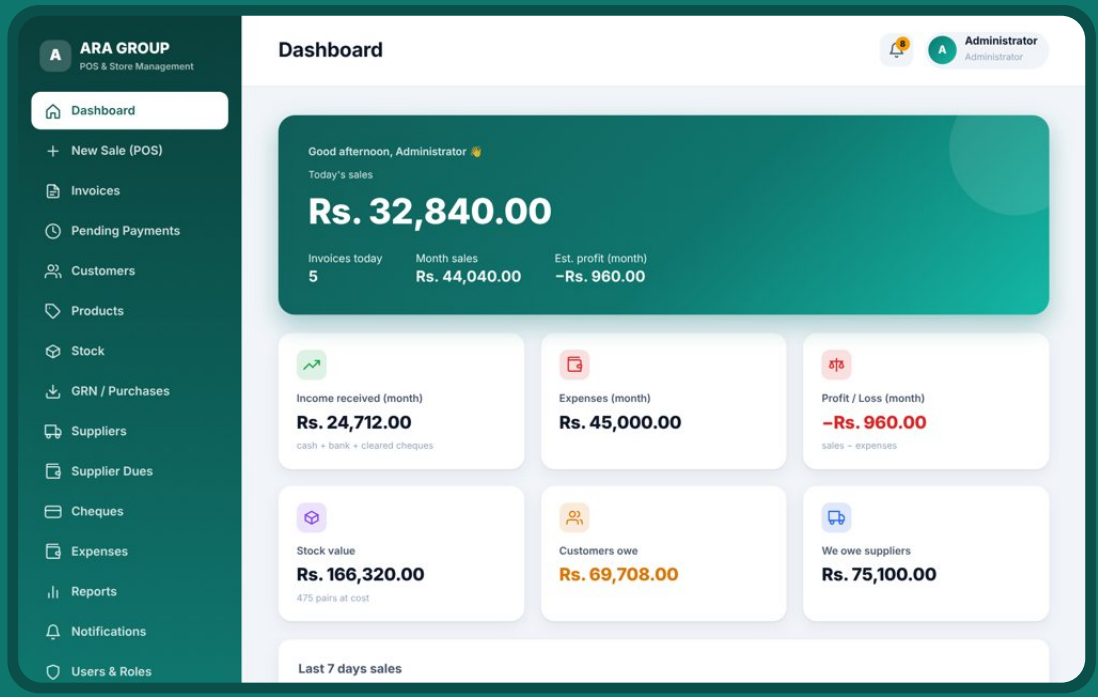
ARA GROUP

POS & Store Management System

Desktop User Manual

For use on a shop or office computer (laptop or desktop). Step-by-step guide to every screen: sales, stock, payments, cheques, expenses, reports, users and settings.



Contents

1	Getting Started	3
2	Dashboard	4
3	Products	5
4	Stock Control	6
5	GRN - Goods Received from Suppliers	7
6	Making a Sale (POS)	8
7	Payments: Cash, Cheque, Credit	9
8	Invoices	10
9	Adding Payments Later	11
10	Pending Payments & Reminders	12
11	Customer Deposits (Advance Payments)	13
12	Using a Deposit on an Invoice	15
13	Overpayments - Extra Money Becomes Advance	16
14	Customers & Statements	17
15	Cheques	18
16	Suppliers	19
17	Paying Suppliers & Supplier Dues	20
18	Expenses	21
19	Salaries & Materials by Item	22
20	Reports	23
21	Filters, Date Ranges & Exports	24
22	Notifications	25
23	Users, Roles & Permissions	26
24	Settings: Company & WhatsApp	27
25	Settings: Email, Templates, Alerts, Backup	28
26	Daily Routine & Good Practice	29
27	Questions & Answers	30
28	Quick Reference	31

1. Getting Started

ARA POS is a web system. Open it in Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari on your shop or office computer - there is nothing to install.

Signing in

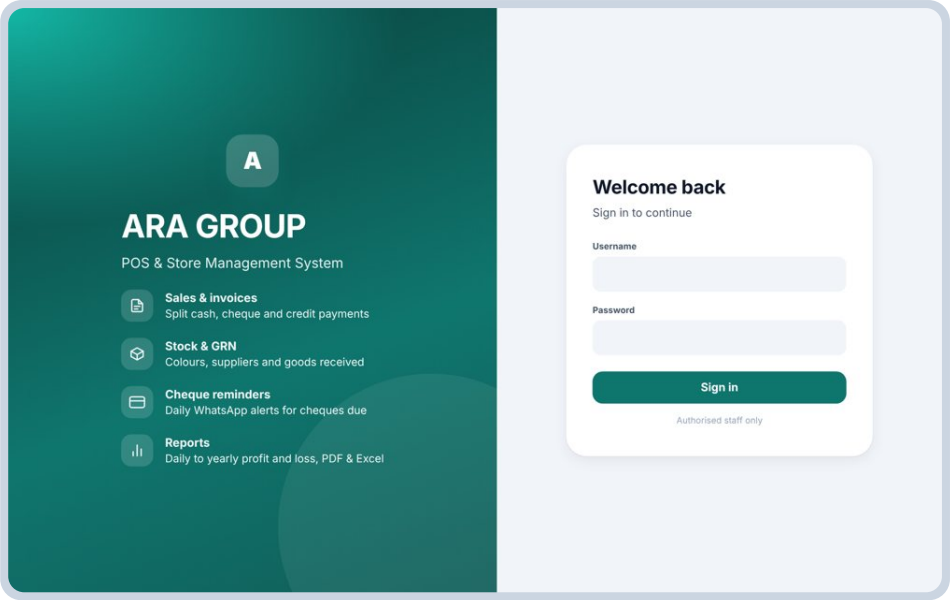
1. Open the address given by your administrator (for example https://pos.yourdomain.com).
2. Type your username and password, then click Sign in.
3. The first administrator login is admin / admin123. Change it immediately in Users (open your own user and set a new password).

Optional: install as a desktop app

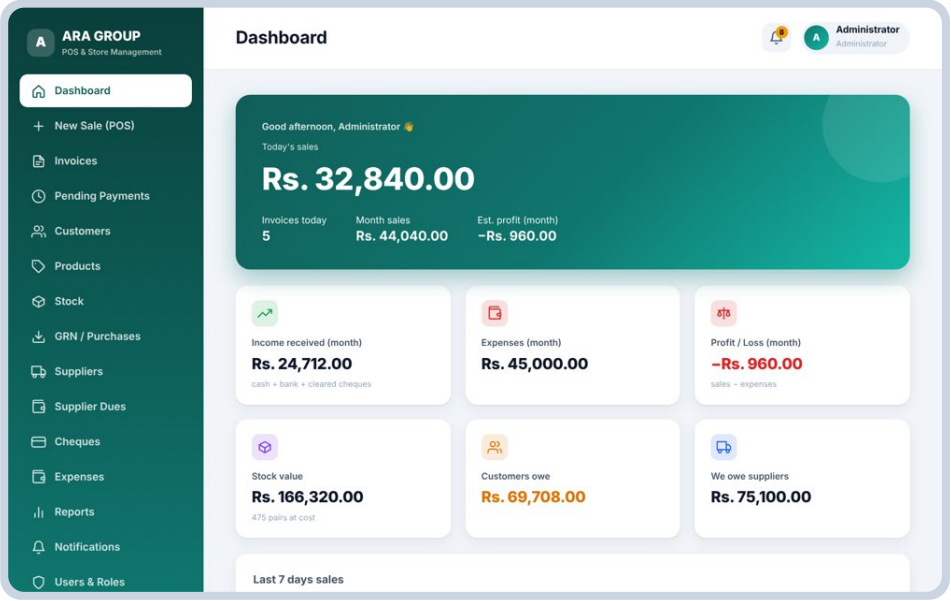
- Chrome / Edge: click the install icon at the right end of the address bar.
- It then opens in its own window with its own icon, like a normal program.

Finding your way around

- Left menu: every section - Dashboard, New Sale (POS), Invoices, Pending Payments, Customers, Products, Stock, Suppliers, Cheques, Expenses, Reports, Notifications, Users & Roles, Settings and Activity Log.
- Top bar: the page title, a back arrow on detail pages, and the bell for new alerts.
- Forms open as pop-up windows in the middle of the screen. Press Esc or click outside to close.
- Logout is at the bottom of the left menu.
- You only see the menus your role allows. If something is missing, ask the administrator to change your role.



Sign-in screen



Left menu and dashboard

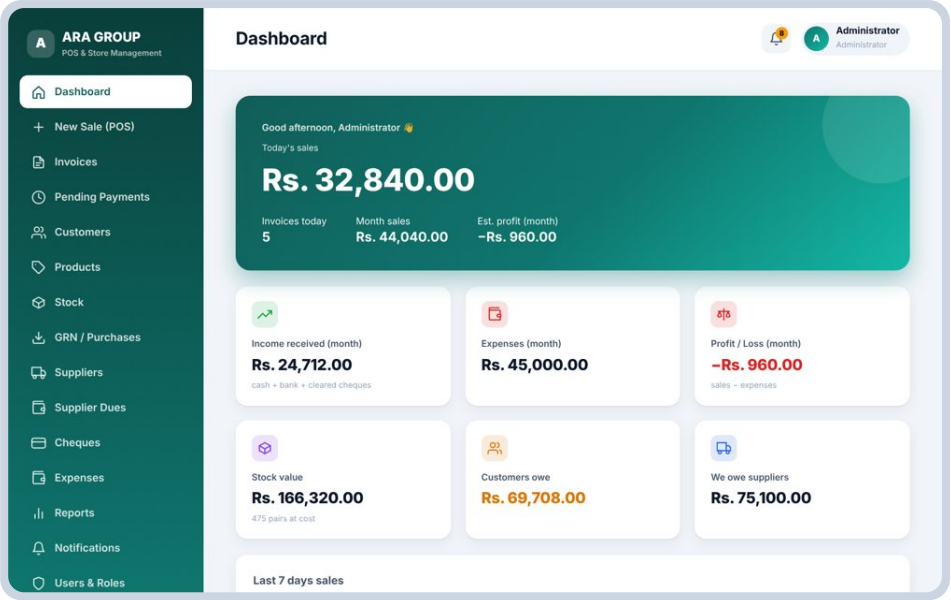
2. Dashboard

The Home screen answers "how is the business doing right now?" at a glance.

What you see

- Today's sales, number of invoices today and this month's sales in the green card.
- Income received this month: cash + bank + cleared cheques only.
- Expenses this month and Profit / Loss (sales minus expenses).
- Stock value (quantity x cost price) and total pairs in the store.
- Customers owe: total outstanding balances. We owe suppliers: supplier balances.
- Last 7 days sales chart.
- Customer cheques to deposit and supplier cheques to pay in the next 7 days (red = overdue).
- Low stock products that need re-ordering.

> Click any "All" / "View" button to jump to the full list. Click a recent invoice to open it.



Dashboard

3. Products

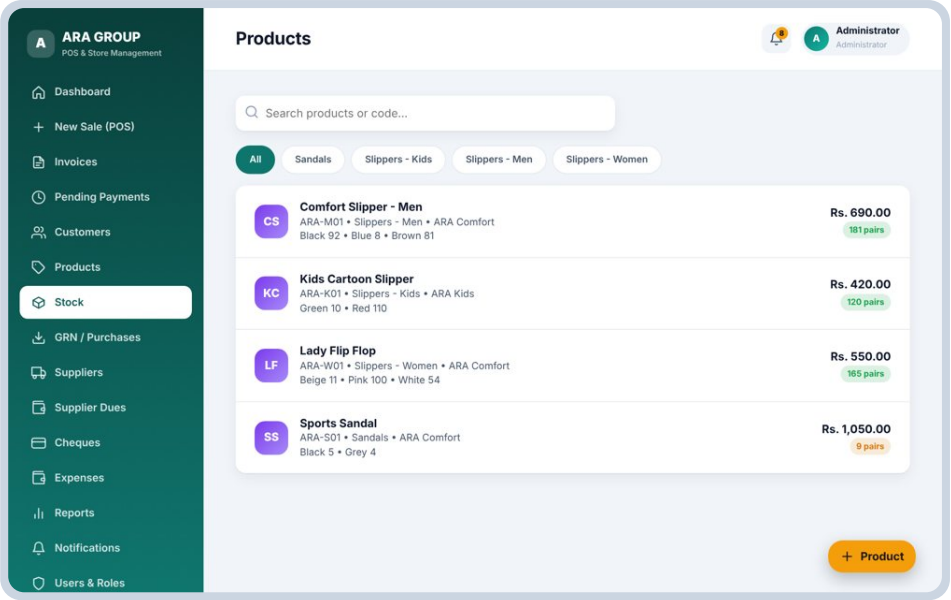
Products are finished slippers. Each product has one or more stock lines - a line is one colour and size kept at one location.

Add a product

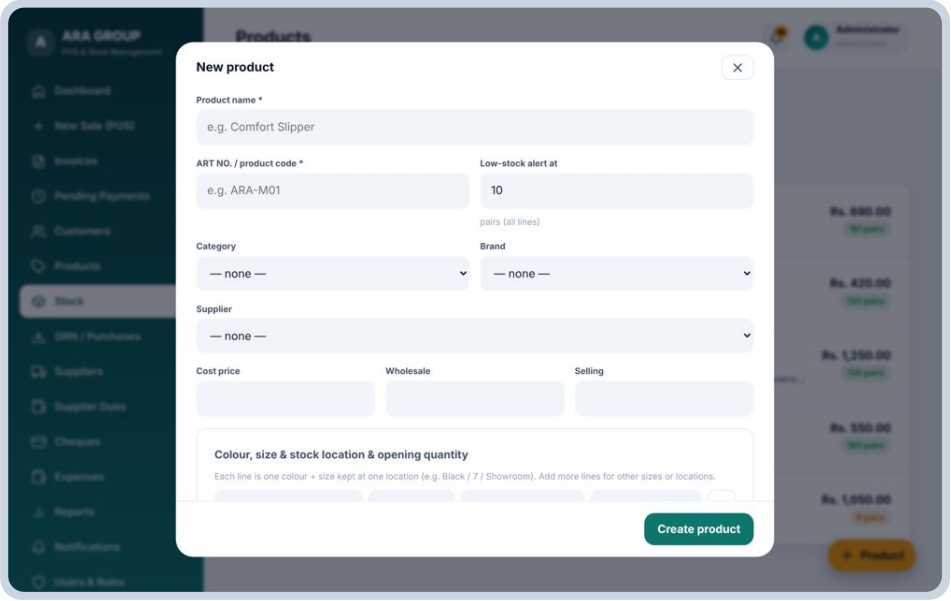
1. Open Products in the left menu and click the orange + Product button.
2. Enter the Product name and the ART NO. / product code (it must be unique).
3. Choose Category, Brand and Supplier. If it is not in the list choose "+ Add new..." at the bottom of the list, type the name and it is selected automatically.
4. Enter Cost price, Wholesale price and Selling price.
5. Under Colour, size & stock location, add one line for each colour and size at each place you keep it - for example Black / size 7 / Showroom - with its Opening quantity. Click Add line for more lines.
6. Set the Low-stock alert number, then click Create product.

Edit or delete

- Click a product to see its details and stock by colour, size and location, then Edit or the bin icon.
- In Edit you can rename lines, add new sizes and locations and change prices. Existing stock is changed only through Stock actions so there is always a record.
- A product that has been sold cannot be erased - it is made inactive instead and disappears from the POS.



Product list



New product with size and location lines

4. Stock Control

Stock goes up when you receive goods and down when you sell. Every change is recorded with date, user and reason, and you can filter stock and history any way you need.

Receive goods into the store

Receiving goods is done with a GRN (Goods Received Note) - see the GRN section. The Receive goods (GRN) button and the Receive action on any stock row both open the GRN form.

Filter stock

- Open Stock > Stock levels and use the Filter stock bar: ART NO., product name, category, size, colour, stock location, supplier, and Low / out of stock only.
- Combine as many filters as you like - for example ART NO. + size 6 + location Factory Store.
- The boxes above the list show the number of lines, total pairs, stock value and low-stock lines for exactly what is filtered.
- PDF and Excel export the filtered list (opening, in, out and closing quantities).

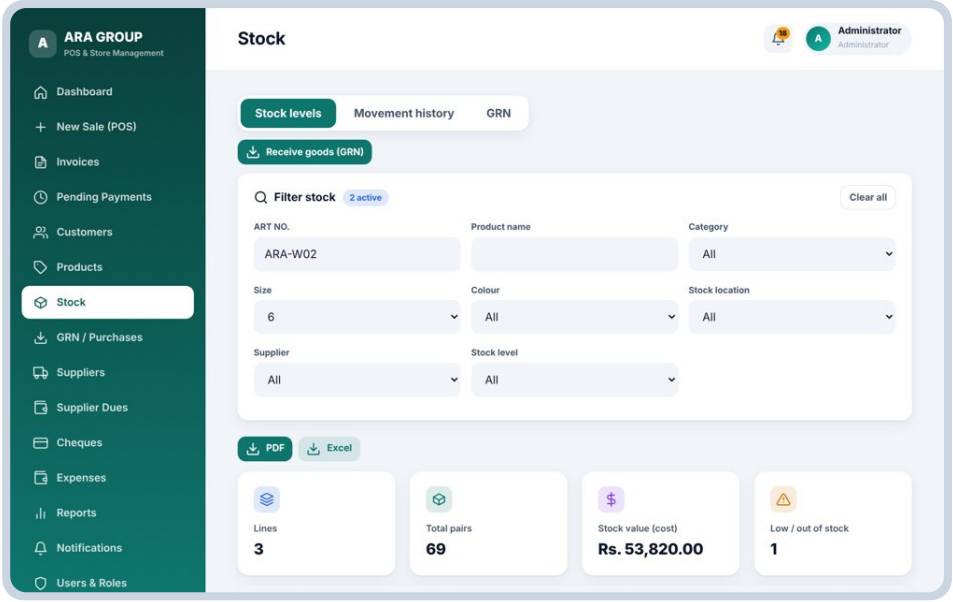
Returns, damages and adjustments

Click any row in Stock levels and choose Customer return (adds stock), Return to supplier, Damaged, or Adjust (plus or minus after a count; a reason is required).

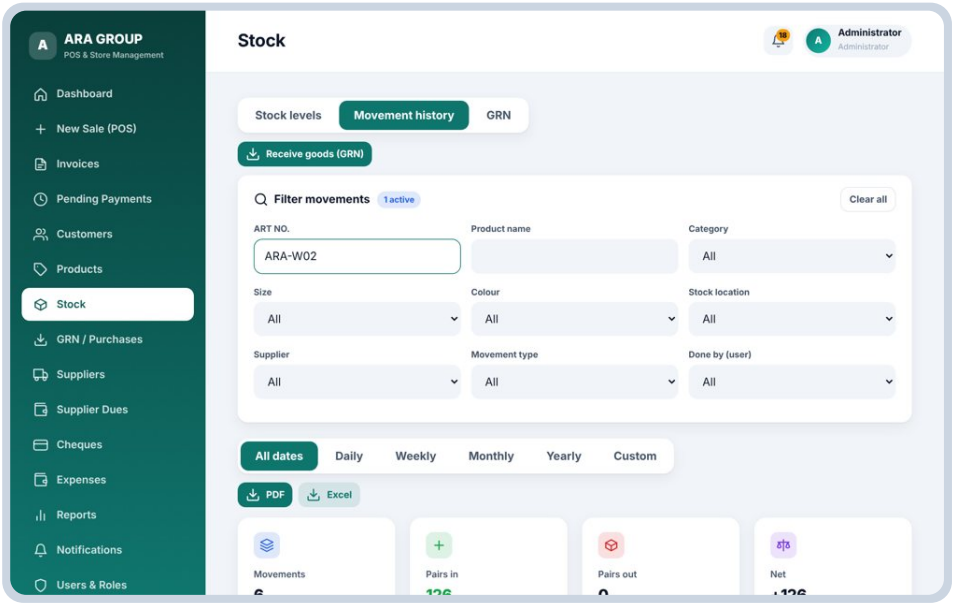
Complete movement history

- Stock > Movement history lists every change: date and time, type, ART NO., product, colour, size, location, quantity, balance after and who did it.
- Use the same filters plus Movement type and Done by (user), and choose a period: All dates, Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly or Custom.
- Click History on a stock row (or a product) to see the history of just that item.
- Load more shows older movements. PDF and Excel export the filtered history.

> Low-stock lines are orange and out-of-stock lines are red. Use the Low / out of stock filter to build your re-order list.



Stock filters



Stock movement history

5. GRN - Goods Received from Suppliers

A GRN records every delivery you receive. It adds the pairs to stock, keeps what you owe the supplier, and tracks your payments to that supplier - the same way invoices work for customers.

Create a GRN

1. Open GRN / Purchases and click + GRN (or Stock > Receive goods).
2. Choose the Supplier (use "Add new supplier" if needed), the received date, the delivery note number and the payment due date.
3. Under Items, choose product and colour, then enter the quantity and the unit cost. Click Add item for more lines. Tick the box to update each product's cost price.
4. Under Payment to supplier now, choose Pay later, 100% Cash or 50/50, or build your own split of Cash, Bank transfer and Cheque.
5. For a cheque enter the cheque number, bank, cheque date and the date it will be presented to the bank.
6. Click Save GRN & update stock. The stock goes up straight away.

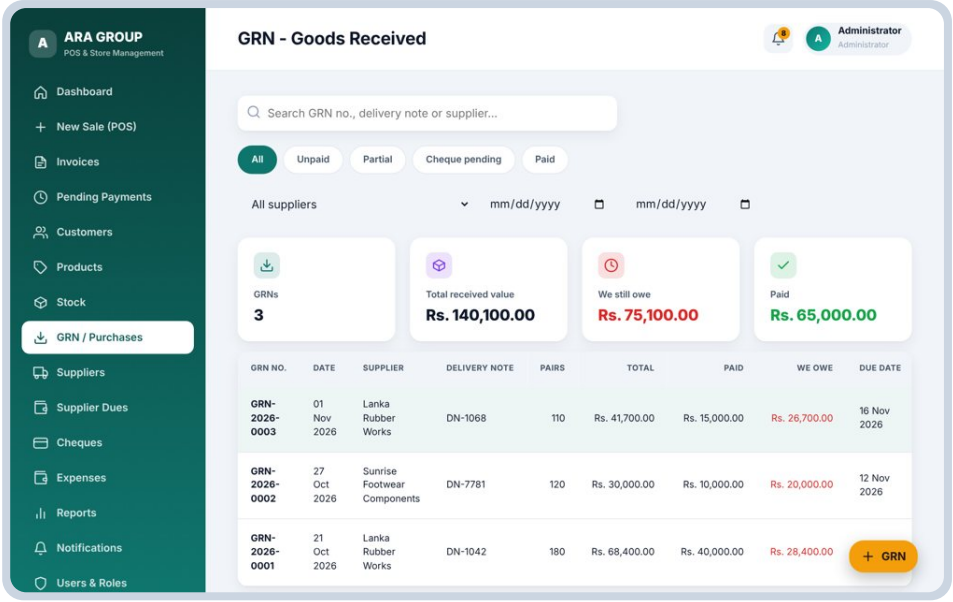
GRN page

- Items, total, paid, cheques issued but not cleared, and what you still owe.
- Status: Unpaid, Partially Paid, Cheque Pending or Paid.
- Payments made, with Pay supplier for later payments. Edit, Delete (stock is reversed) and PDF buttons.

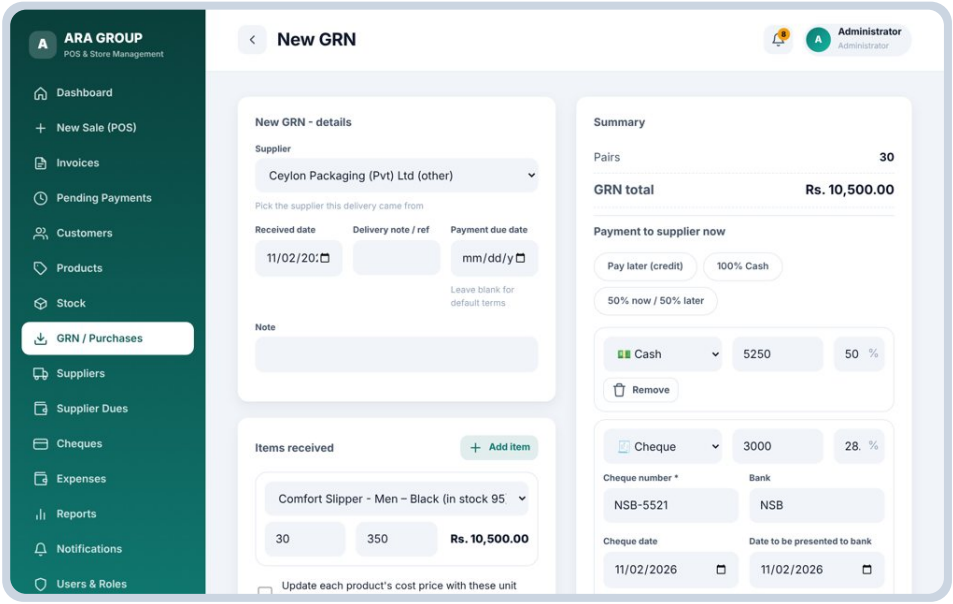
Filter

The GRN list can be filtered by supplier (supplier-wise GRNs), status, dates and search.

> A cheque you issue is NOT counted as paid until you mark it Cleared in Cheques. Until then the GRN shows Cheque Pending.



GRN list



New GRN with split payment

6. Making a Sale (POS)

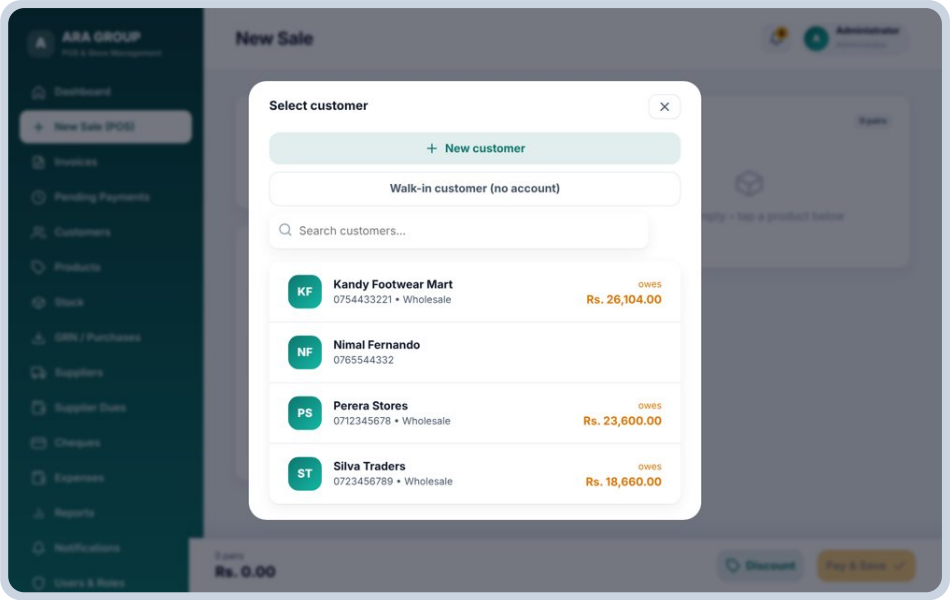
New Sale (POS) in the left menu opens the point of sale. It also works well on touch-screen computers.

Create an invoice

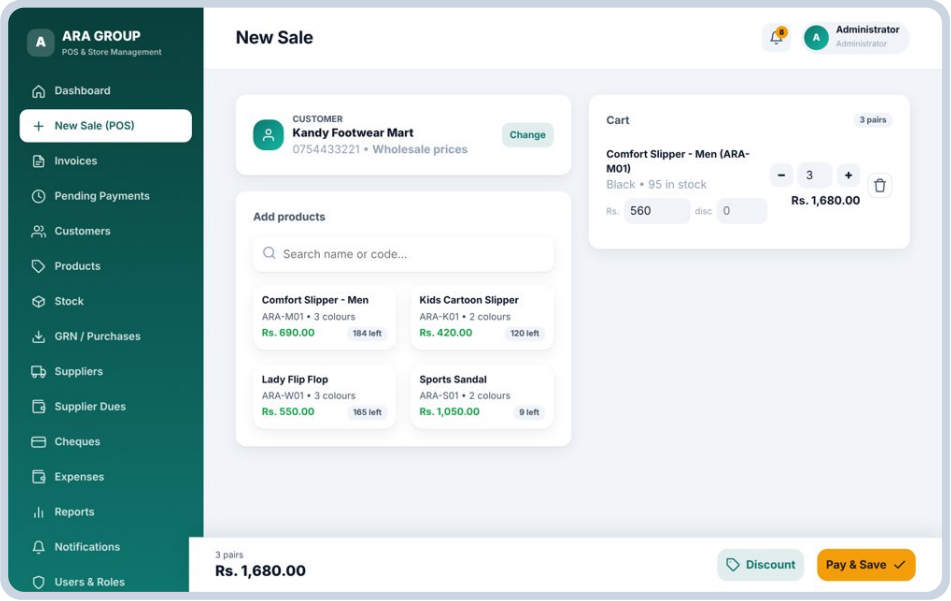
1. Click the Customer card. Choose an existing customer, click New customer, or choose Walk-in customer. A customer is needed for credit sales, WhatsApp and email.
2. Search or scroll the products and click one. If it has several colours, choose the colour.
3. In the cart change the quantity with + / -, or edit the price and a line discount.
4. Click Discount for an invoice-level discount.
5. Click Pay & Save to take payment (next page).

> Wholesale customers automatically get wholesale prices. You can still change any price in the cart.

> The system will not sell more than you have in stock (unless the administrator allowed negative stock).



Choose customer



Cart with quantity and price

7. Payments: Cash, Cheque, Credit

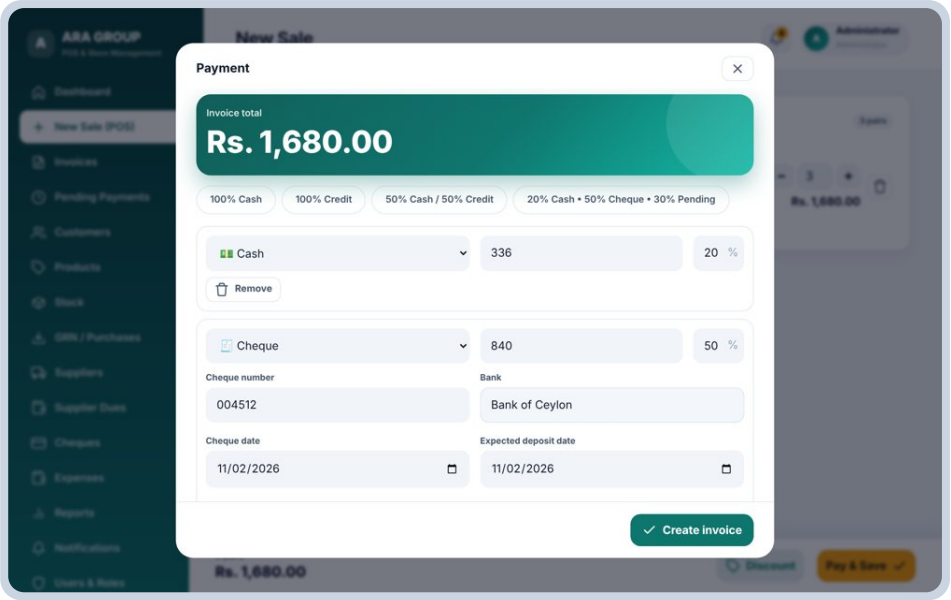
One invoice can be paid in several ways at once. Whatever is not paid is automatically kept as Pending for that customer.

Split an invoice

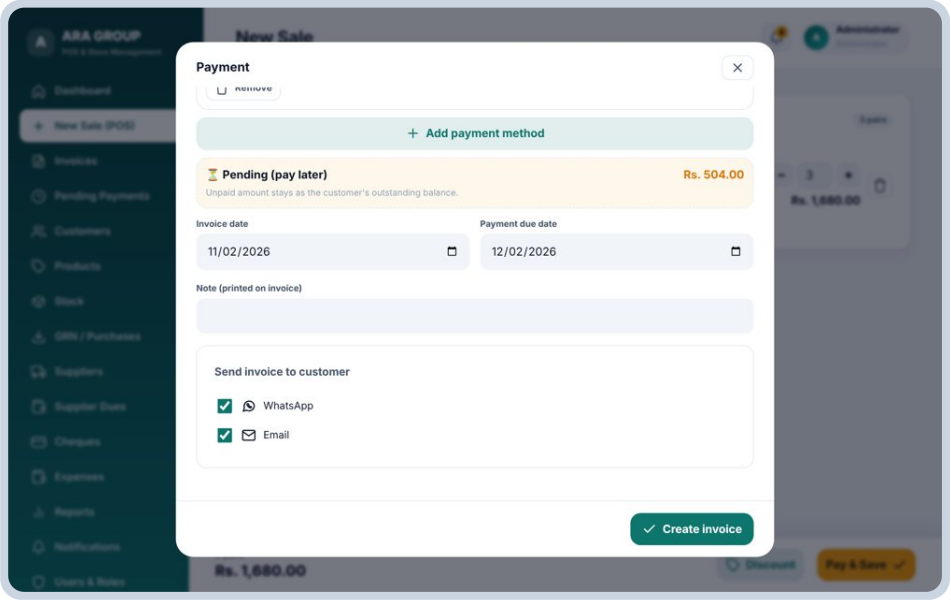
1. After Pay & Save, the payment screen shows the invoice total.
2. Use a quick button - 100% Cash, 100% Credit, 50/50, or 20% cash / 50% cheque / 30% pending - or build your own.
3. Each row has a method (Cash, Bank transfer, Cheque), an amount and a percentage. Change either; the other updates.
4. Click Add payment method for more rows. The orange Pending box shows what is left.
5. For a cheque enter the cheque number, bank, cheque date and expected deposit date.
6. If money is still pending, set the payment due date.
7. Tick WhatsApp / Email to send the invoice, then click Create invoice.

> Example: Rs. 100,000 invoice = 20% cash (20,000) + 50% cheque (50,000) + 30% pending (30,000).

> A cheque is NOT treated as received money until you mark it Cleared in the Cheques section.



Split payment



Dates and sending options

8. Invoices

Everything about a sale is on its invoice page. Invoice numbers are automatic: ARA-2026-00001, 00002 ...

After creating an invoice

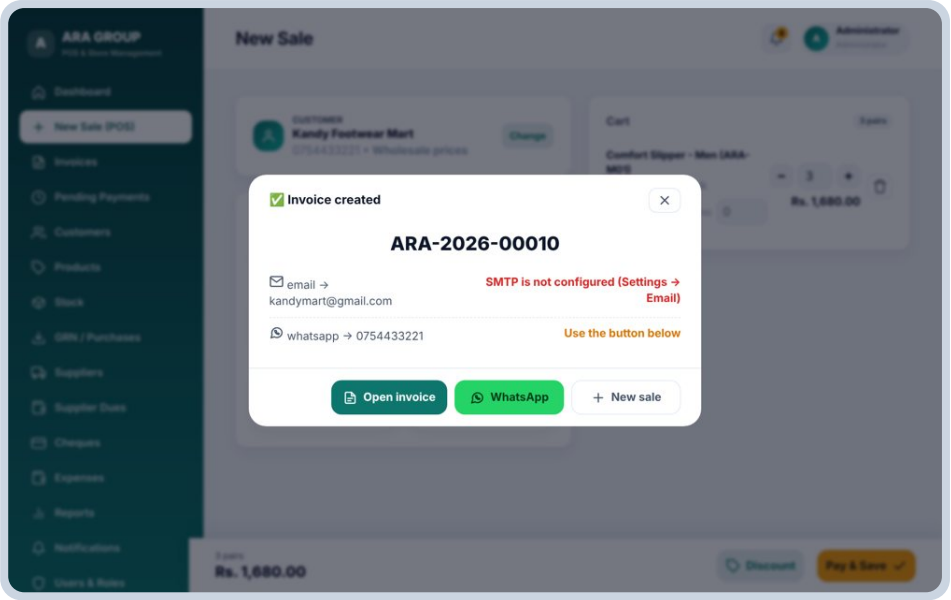
- A confirmation shows the invoice number and the result of the email / WhatsApp sending.
- Open invoice, WhatsApp (opens WhatsApp with the message ready) and New sale buttons are offered.

Invoice page

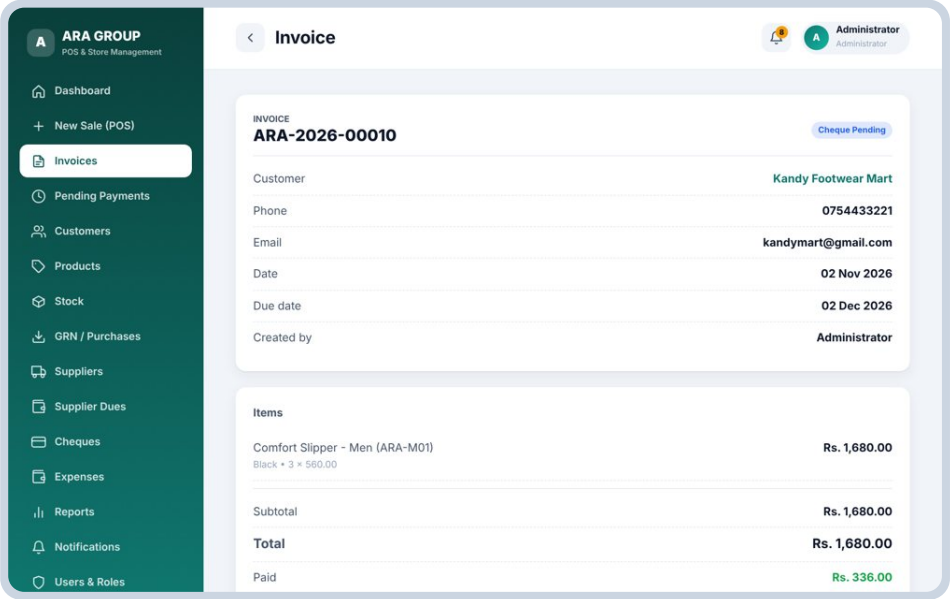
- Customer, dates, items, totals, paid amount, cheque amount not yet cleared and balance due.
- Status: Unpaid, Partially Paid, Pending, Cheque Pending or Paid.
- Payments list with edit and delete buttons. Add payment records a later payment (any date, any method).
- PDF, WhatsApp, Email, Edit and Delete buttons.
- Delivery log: every WhatsApp / email that was sent and whether it worked.

Edit or delete

Edit changes customer, items, prices, discount and dates; stock is corrected automatically. Delete returns the stock and removes the invoice and its payments. Both are written to the Activity Log with your name.



Invoice created



Invoice page

9. Adding Payments Later

Customers often take goods first and pay later, in parts. Record every payment against the invoice.

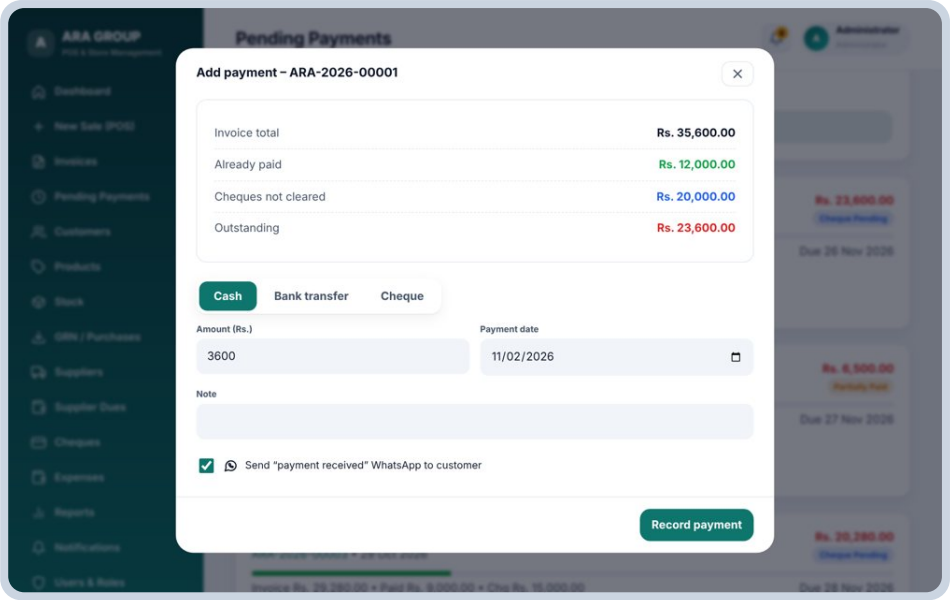
Record a payment

1. Open the invoice and click Add payment (or use the button on the Pending Payments page).
2. Choose Cash, Bank transfer or Cheque. The amount is pre-filled with the outstanding balance - change it for a part payment.
3. Pick the payment date. For a cheque fill in the cheque details.
4. Tick the WhatsApp box to tell the customer "payment received".
5. Click Record payment. The invoice status and the customer balance update immediately.

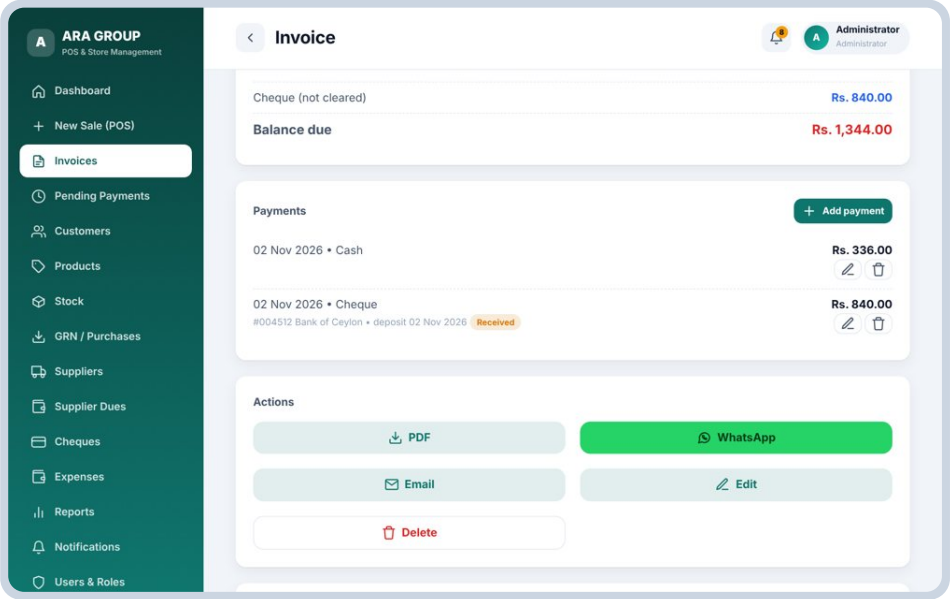
Automatic statuses

- Unpaid - nothing paid, no credit arrangement.
- Pending - sold on credit, balance outstanding.
- Partially Paid - some cleared money received.
- Cheque Pending - cheque taken but not cleared.
- Paid - the full amount is settled with cleared money.

> You cannot record more than the remaining balance. To correct a mistake, edit or delete the payment on the invoice page.



Add payment



Payments on an invoice

10. Pending Payments & Reminders

Pending Payments lists every invoice that still has a balance.

What it shows

- Customer, invoice number and date, invoice amount, amount paid, outstanding balance, due date and a progress bar.
- Payment history for each invoice (click to expand).

Filters

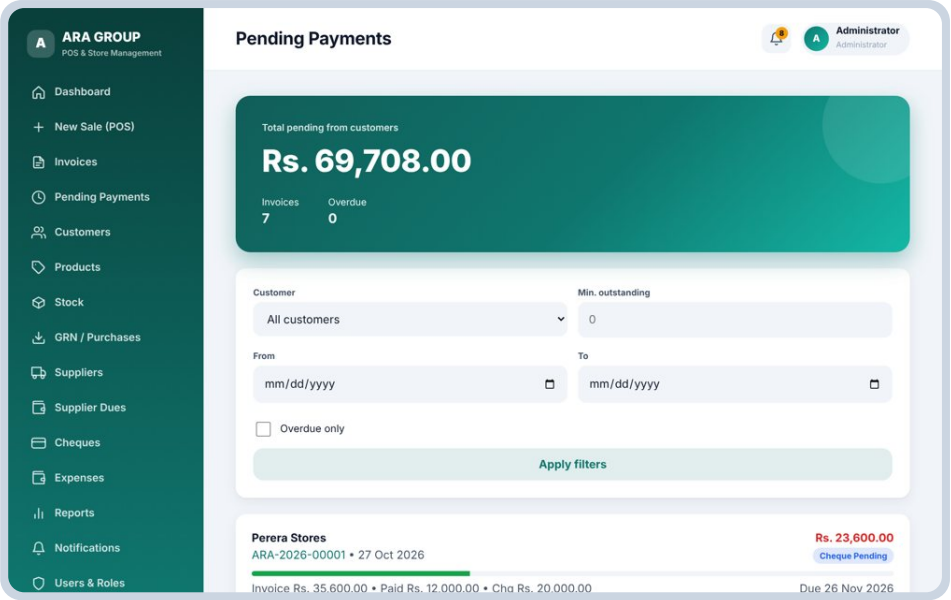
Customer, from / to date, minimum outstanding amount, and Overdue only.

Actions

- Add payment - record money received.
- Remind - sends the overdue-reminder template on WhatsApp. If the gateway is off, WhatsApp opens with the message ready to send.

Automatic reminders

The system checks every 30 minutes. Overdue invoices create a notification (bell icon). In Settings > Alerts you can also forward alerts to your own WhatsApp / email, or let the system WhatsApp customers when an invoice becomes overdue.



Pending payments

11. Customer Deposits (Advance Payments)

Customers can pay money in advance into their ARA Group customer account and use it later on invoices. Every change of the advance balance is recorded in a ledger.

Record a deposit

1. Open Customer Deposits and click + Record deposit (or open a customer and click Deposit).
2. Choose the customer, the date and an optional receipt / reference number. A receipt number such as DEP-2026-00001 is created automatically if you leave it blank.
3. Choose Cash, Bank transfer or Cheque and enter the amount. Click Add another payment for a mix, for example cash + cheque.
4. For a cheque enter the cheque number, bank, cheque date and the expected deposit date, then click Save deposit.

Deposit status - what is available

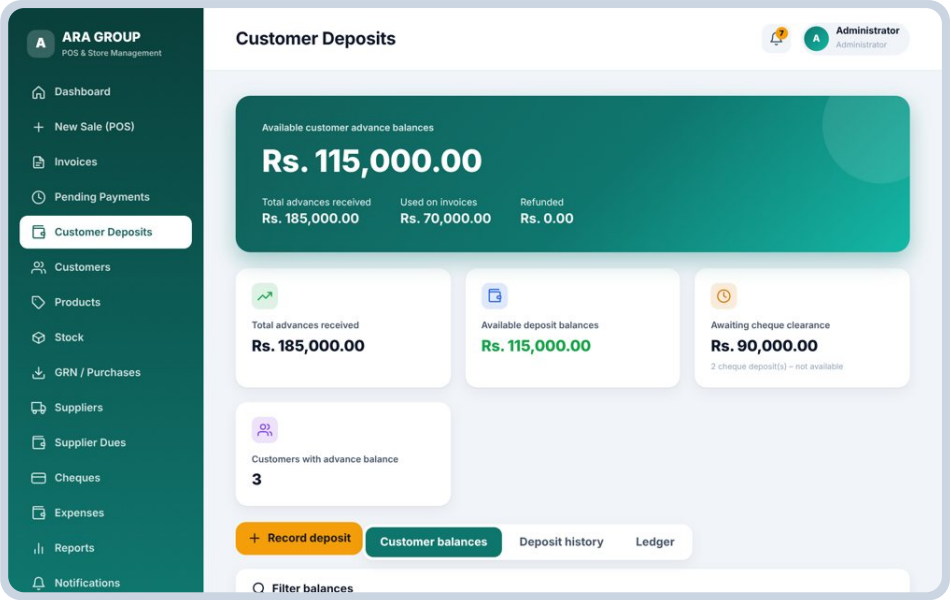
- Cash and bank transfers are Cleared at once and available immediately. Money a customer overpays on an invoice is saved here automatically too (see Overpayments).
- A cheque deposit is Pending until you mark the cheque Cleared in Cheques. Pending and Bounced cheques are NEVER available for invoices.
- If a cleared cheque later bounces, the money is taken back out of the customer's balance automatically.

Deposit dashboard

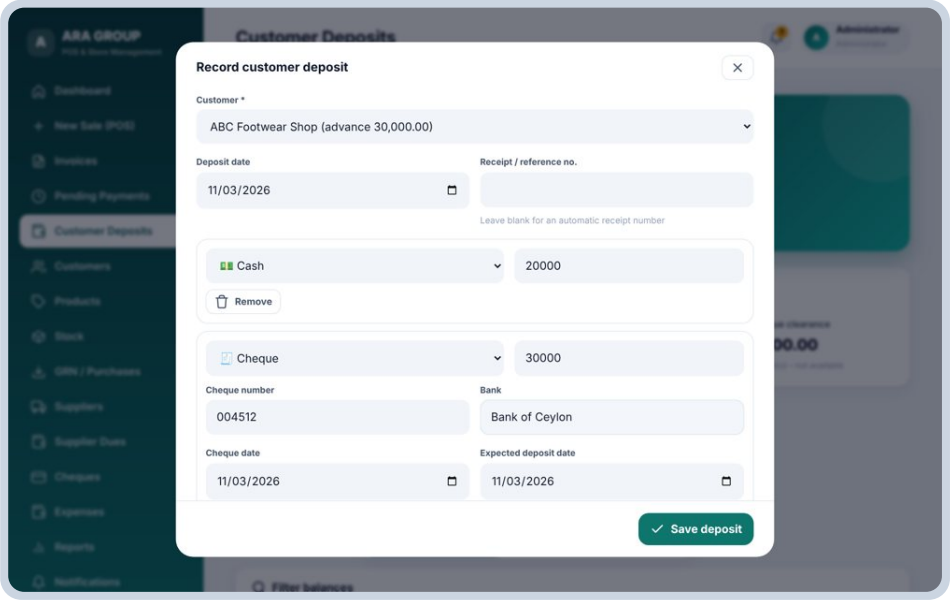
- Total advances received, available deposit balances, deposits awaiting cheque clearance and customers with an advance balance.
- Tabs: Customer balances, Deposit history and Ledger - each with filters and PDF / Excel export.
- Refund: open a customer > Deposits tab > Refund to pay money back; it reduces the balance and is recorded.

> Only cleared cash, bank transfers and cleared cheques can be used on invoices.

Deposits are not counted as income twice: they count when received, and using them on an invoice is just a transfer.



Customer Deposits dashboard



Record a deposit (cash + cheque)

12. Using a Deposit on an Invoice

When you make a sale for a customer who has an advance balance, the system checks it automatically and uses it for the invoice.

Automatic deduction

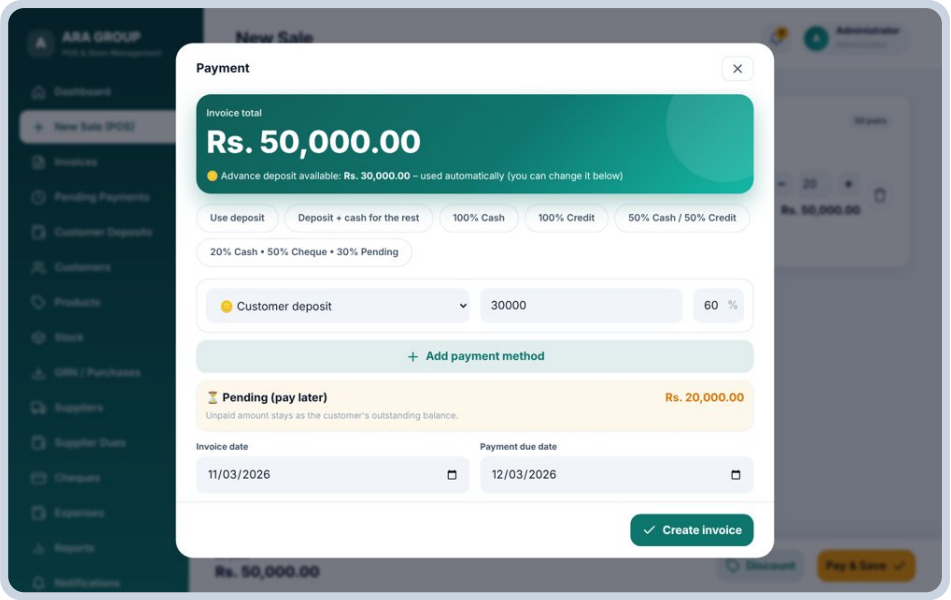
1. Choose the customer in New Sale as usual. Their advance balance is shown on the customer card.
2. Click Pay & Save. The payment screen already has a Customer deposit row filled in with the amount that can be used (never more than the balance or the invoice total).
3. Change it if you wish, add Cash, Bank transfer, Cheque or leave the rest Pending, then Create invoice.

Examples

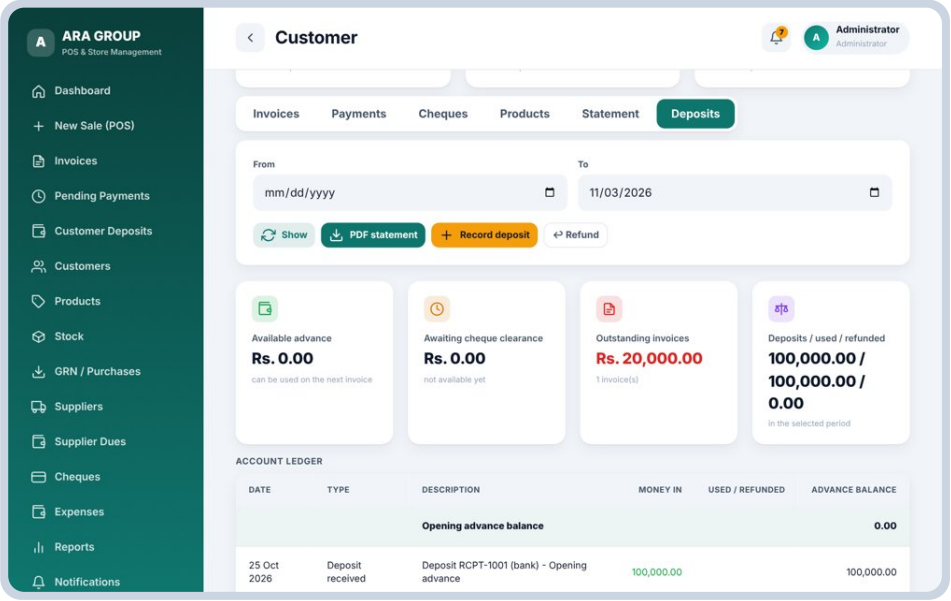
- Deposit Rs. 100,000, invoice Rs. 70,000: Rs. 70,000 is deducted, the invoice is Paid and Rs. 30,000 stays in the account as advance balance for the next invoice.
- Next invoice Rs. 50,000: the Rs. 30,000 advance is used automatically, Rs. 20,000 remains and the invoice shows Partially Paid.
- Mixed: invoice Rs. 100,000 = deposit 30,000 + cash 20,000 + cheque 30,000 + pending 20,000. The outstanding amount is calculated automatically.

Account statement

- Customer > Deposits tab shows the opening advance balance, every deposit (with method and status), deposits used on invoices, refunds, the current available advance and the outstanding invoice balances.
- Click PDF statement to download it for any period.
- If you delete an invoice or a deposit payment, the money returns to the customer's advance balance.



Deposit applied automatically



Customer account statement

13. Overpayments - Extra Money Becomes Advance

If a customer pays more than the invoice total, nothing is lost: the extra is kept in their account as an overpaid / advance balance and is used automatically on their next invoice.

Overpaying an invoice

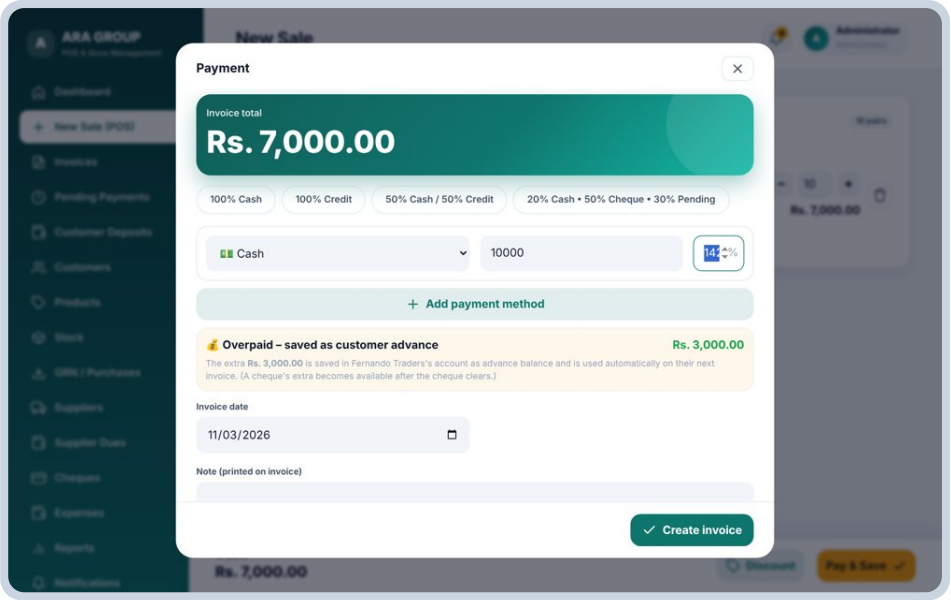
1. In New Sale (or Add payment on an invoice) enter the amount the customer actually gave - cash, bank transfer or cheque - even if it is more than the invoice total.
2. The orange box changes to "Overpaid - saved as customer advance" and shows the extra amount. The invoice is settled for exactly what it needs.
3. Click Create invoice. The extra is saved as a deposit with its own receipt number (DEP-...) and the confirmation shows the new advance balance.

Using it on the next invoice

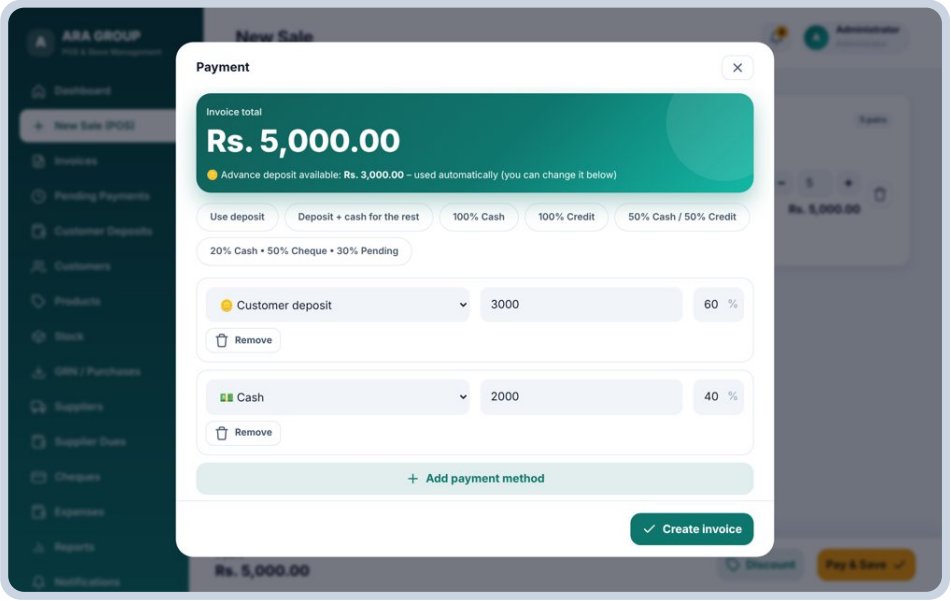
- The next time you sell to that customer, the payment screen already contains a Customer deposit row with the advance filled in. Nothing to remember.
- You can change the amount, remove it, or add cash / bank / cheque / pending for the rest.
- Example: invoice Rs. 7,000, customer gives Rs. 10,000 -> Rs. 3,000 advance. Next invoice Rs. 5,000: Rs. 3,000 is used automatically and Rs. 2,000 is paid in cash.

Cheques and walk-in customers

- If the overpayment is a cheque, the invoice shows Cheque Pending and the extra stays Pending (not available) until the cheque is marked Cleared. It is ONE cheque in the Cheques list.
- A customer must be selected to keep the extra - walk-in sales cannot hold an advance.
- You can see every overpayment in Customer Deposits and in the customer's Deposits tab (note: Overpayment on invoice ...). Use Refund there if you pay the money back.



Overpaid amount saved as advance



Next invoice: advance applied automatically

14. Customers & Statements

Every customer has a separate history. Search by name, phone or email; the Owing money filter shows only customers with balances.

Customer page

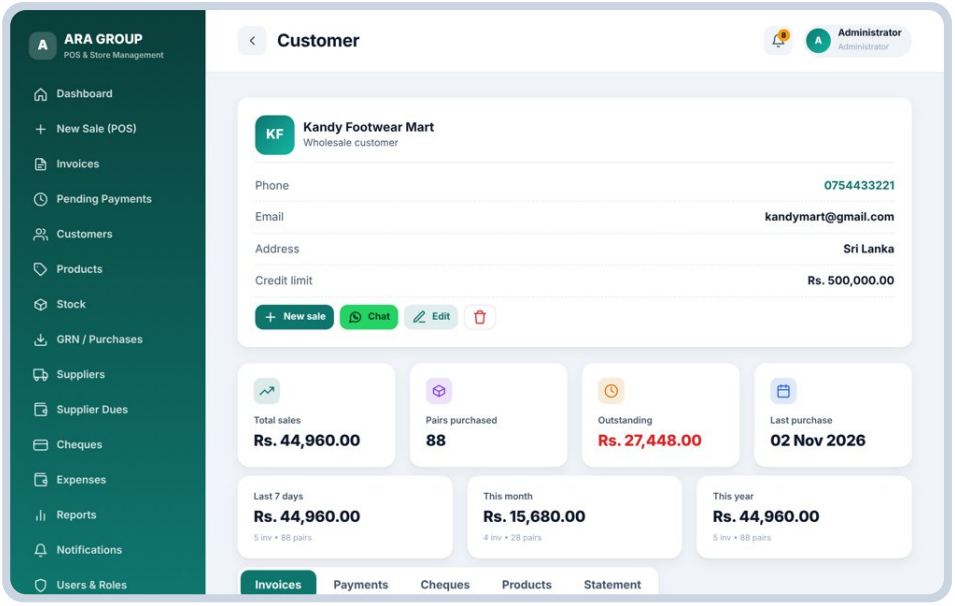
- Total sales, pairs purchased, outstanding balance and last purchase date.
- Sales for the last 7 days, this month and this year.
- Tabs: Invoices, Payments, Cheques, Products bought and Statement.
- Buttons: New sale for this customer, WhatsApp chat, Edit, Delete (a customer with invoices is deactivated instead).

Customer statement

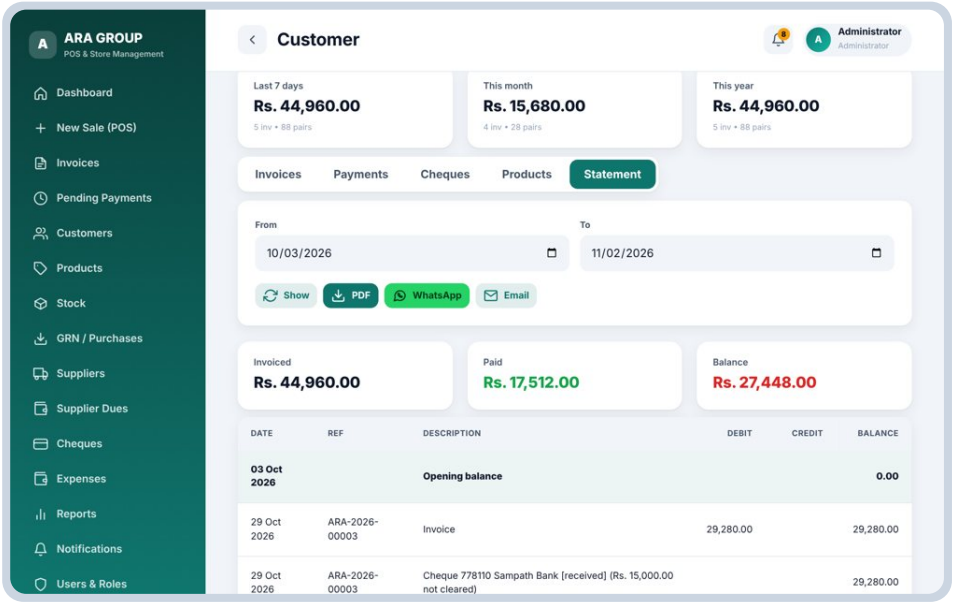
1. Open the customer, click the Statement tab.
2. Choose the From and To dates and click Show: opening balance, every invoice, payment and cheque, and the closing balance.
3. Click PDF to download, or WhatsApp / Email to send it to the customer.

Add a customer

Customers > + Customer. Enter name, type (Retail or Wholesale), phone, WhatsApp number, email, address and credit limit. The email and WhatsApp number are used for automatic invoice delivery.



Customer page



Statement

15. Cheques

Cheques tracks cheques you receive from customers and cheques you give to suppliers. They are on separate tabs: Customer cheques and Supplier cheques.

Customer cheques

- Received - in your hand.
- Deposited - taken to the bank.
- Cleared - money is in your account. Only now is the invoice counted as paid.
- Bounced - returned unpaid. The invoice balance returns and you get an alert. Tick the box to notify the customer on WhatsApp.

Created automatically when you take a cheque payment. Click a cheque to update its status:

Supplier cheques

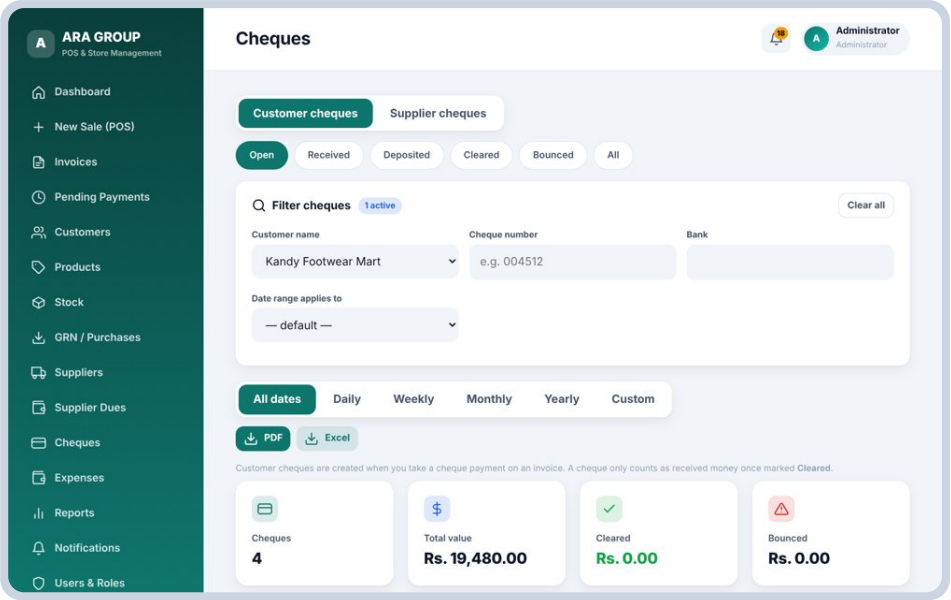
1. Cheques > Supplier cheques > Issue supplier cheque (or pay a GRN or supplier by cheque).
2. Choose the supplier, cheque number, bank, amount, cheque date and the date it will be presented to the bank.
3. Update the status as it moves: Issued, Presented, Cleared or Returned. Cleared reduces the supplier balance.

Filter cheques

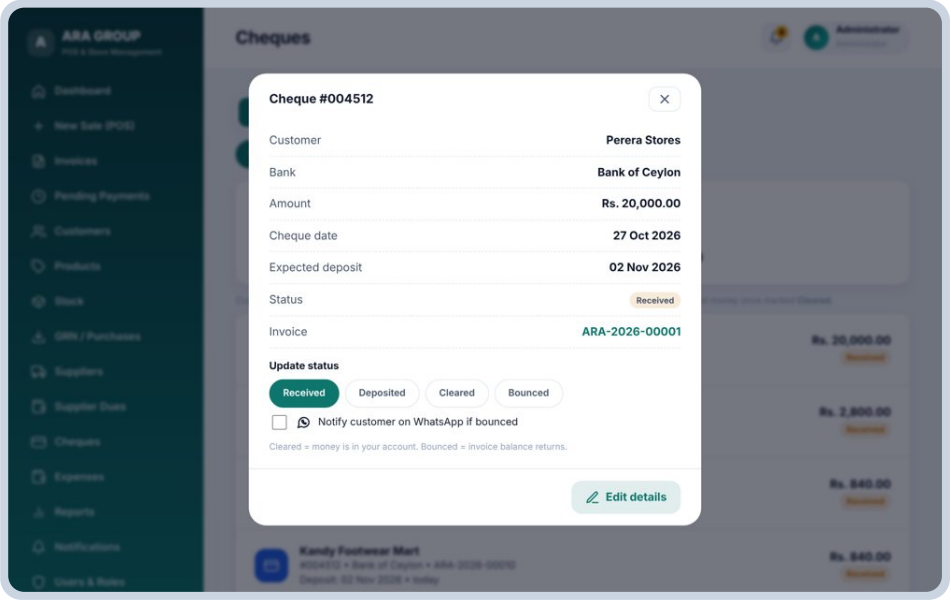
- Filter by customer name (or supplier name), cheque number, bank and status.
- Choose a period and whether it applies to the deposit / presentation date or the cheque date.
- PDF and Excel export the filtered list.

Reminders

You are alerted a few days before every deposit or presentation date, on the day, and when a date has been missed. The daily WhatsApp reminder lists the cheques due today.



Cheque filters



Update cheque status

16. Suppliers

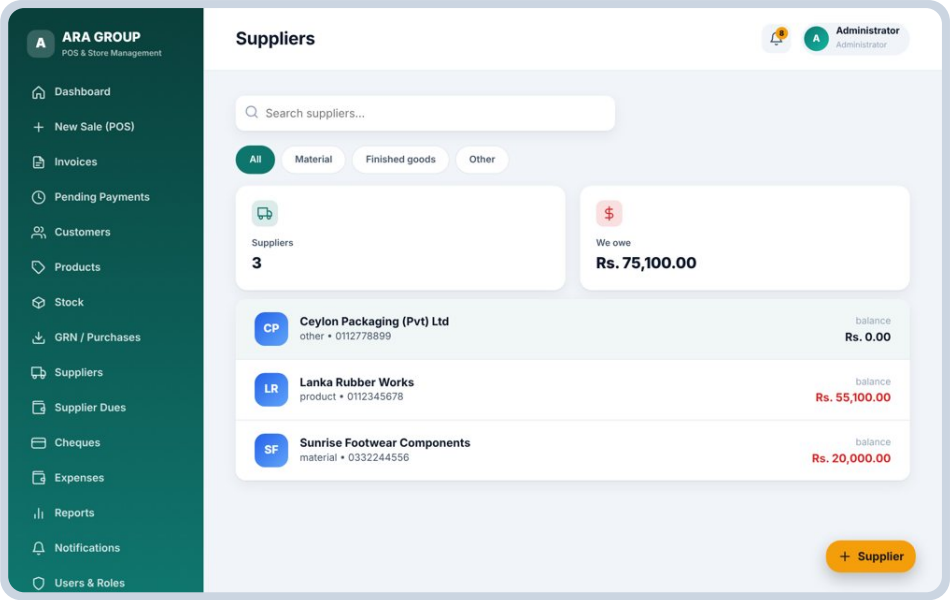
Keep material suppliers, finished-goods suppliers and other suppliers separately.

Supplier page

- Balance owed = opening balance + goods received - payments - cleared cheques.
- Tabs: Payments, Cheques, Goods received, Expenses.
- Payment records cash or bank payments. Issue cheque creates a supplier cheque.

Add a supplier

Suppliers > + Supplier. Enter name, type, contact, phone, email, address and the opening balance you already owe. You can also add a supplier quickly from the product form or the Receive goods form.



Suppliers

17. Paying Suppliers & Supplier Dues

Pay the company's suppliers in cash, bank transfer or cheque - all at once or in parts, on or after the GRN date.

Pay against a GRN

1. Open the GRN (or Supplier Dues) and click Pay supplier.
2. Choose Cash, Bank transfer or Cheque. The amount is pre-filled with what is still owed - change it for a part payment.
3. For a cheque fill in the cheque details and the date to present it.
4. Tick the WhatsApp box to send the supplier a "payment made" message, then click Record payment.

Supplier Dues

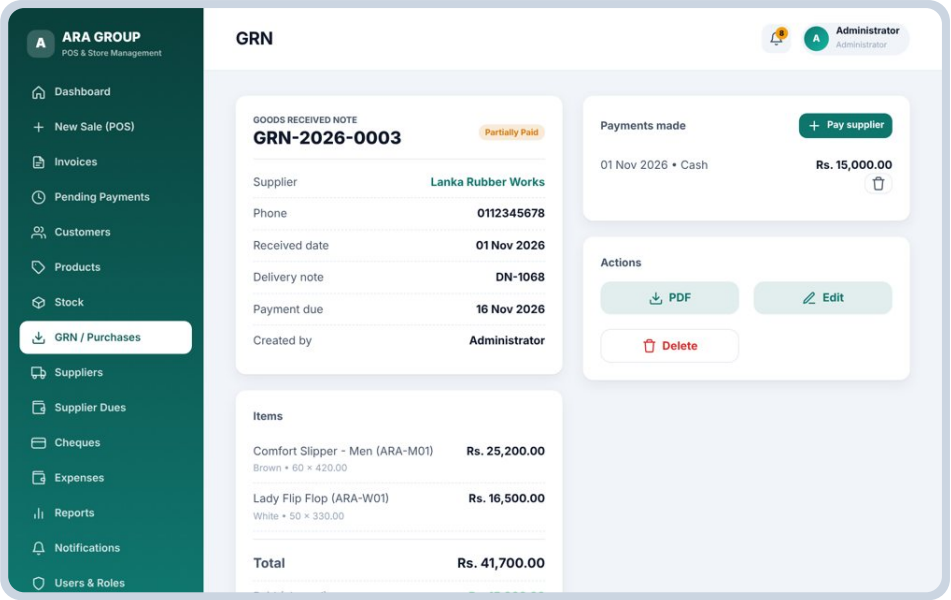
- Lists every GRN that still has a balance: supplier, GRN, date, amount, paid, what you owe, due date and payment history.
- Filter by supplier, dates, minimum amount and Overdue only. You are alerted when a payment is due or overdue.

Supplier statement

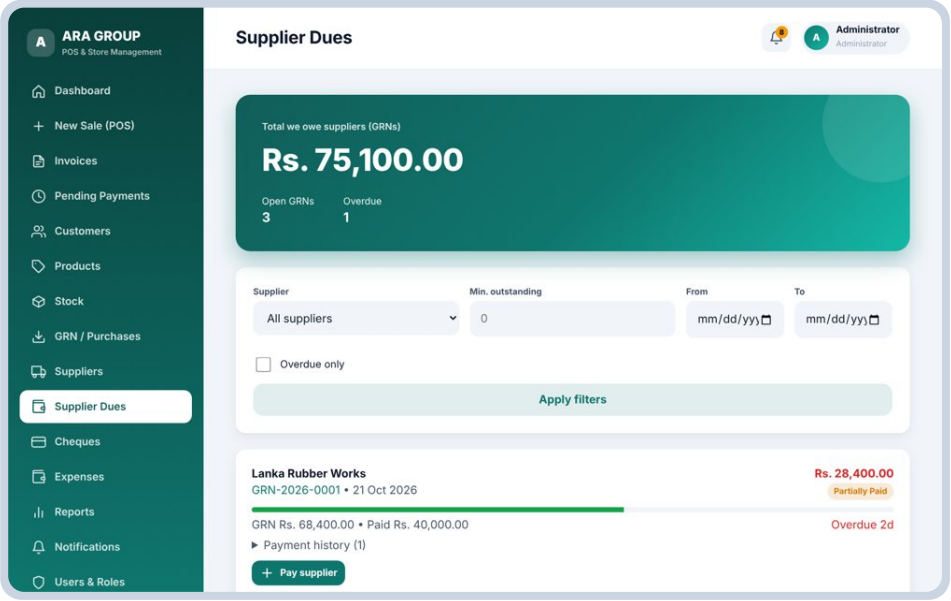
Open a supplier > Statement tab, choose dates and click Show or PDF: opening balance, every GRN, every payment and cheque, and what you owe now.

Supplier cheques

Cheques issued through a GRN appear in Cheques > Supplier cheques. When you mark one Cleared, the GRN and the supplier balance update automatically. Reminders are sent before the presentation date and on the day.



GRN with payments



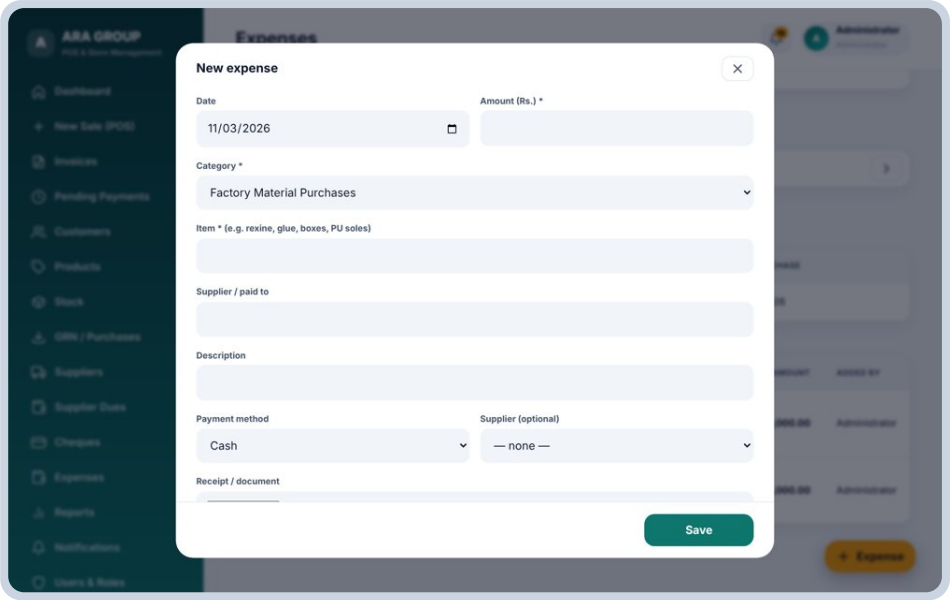
Supplier dues

18. Expenses

Record every business and factory expense, then filter them by category, employee, item and date. Raw materials are recorded here as expenses (they are not tracked as stock).

Add an expense

1. Click + Expense.
2. Enter the date and amount and choose a category: Factory material purchases, Salaries and wages, Factory expenses, Electricity and water, Transport and delivery, Repairs and maintenance, Rent or Other. Use "Add new category" to create your own and say whether it is a general, salary or material category.
3. Salaries: type the Employee name (names you used before are suggested). Materials: type the Item - rexine, glue, boxes, PU soles and so on - and the supplier.
4. Add a description and payment method, and a photo or PDF of the receipt (up to 8 MB), then Save.



New expense - item field for materials

Filters and export

- Combine Category, Employee, Item, Supplier, Payment method, search text, minimum and maximum amount and a period (All dates, Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly, Custom).
- The total at the top, the category boxes and the payment history all follow your filters.
- Click a category box to filter by it. Click an expense for details, the receipt, and who added or edited it.
- PDF and Excel export the same view (a salary or materials report when those categories are selected).

19. Salaries & Materials by Item

Two special expense categories give you totals per employee and per item.

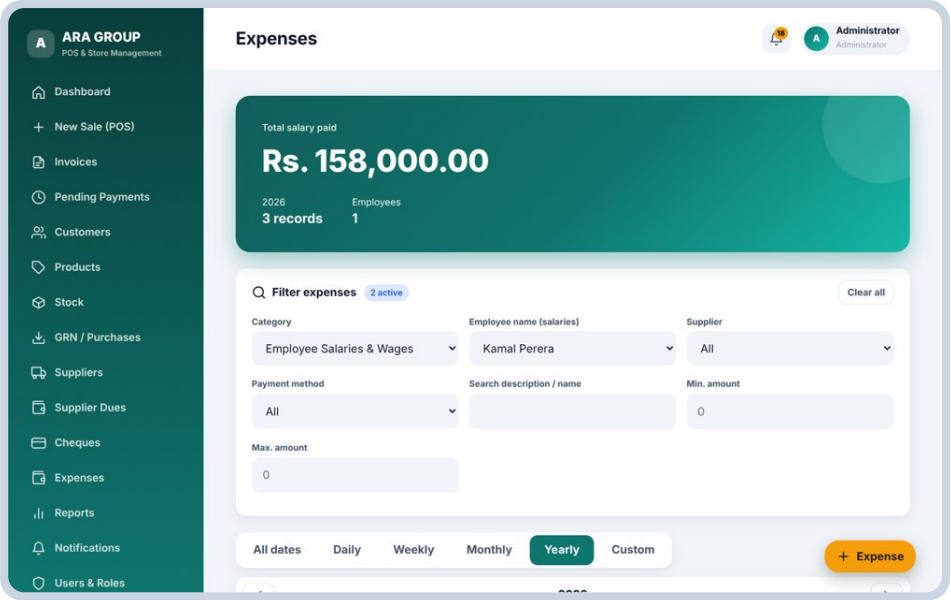
Salaries - by employee

- Filter Category: Salaries, then pick an Employee name.
- Salary paid per employee shows the total paid, number of payments, and the first and last payment dates.
- Click an employee for their complete payment history - every payment date and amount - with PDF and Excel.
- Reports > Expenses > Salaries gives the same for a month, a year or custom dates, with a subtotal for each employee.

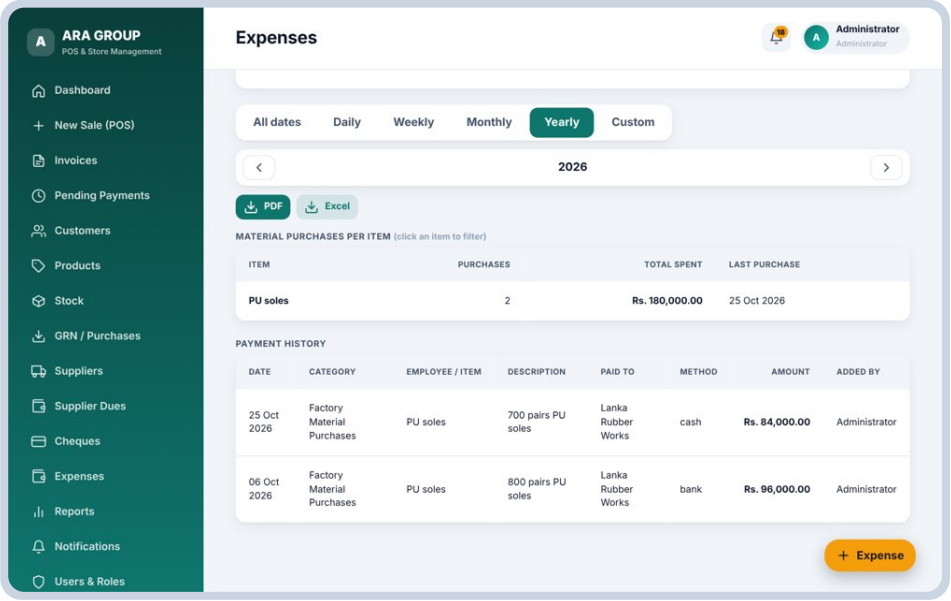
Materials - by item

- Filter Category: Materials, then pick an Item such as rexine, glue, boxes or PU soles.
- Material purchases per item shows the total spent, number of purchases and the last purchase date.
- Click an item row to filter the list to just that item.
- Reports > Expenses > Materials gives a per-item report with subtotals.

> Salary and material expenses need the employee name or item, so the totals stay accurate. Names you have used before appear as suggestions - type them the same way each time.



Salaries by employee



Materials by item

20. Reports

Reports gives income, expenses, profit and loss and detailed listings for any day, week, month, year or custom range - and every report has its own filters.

Using reports

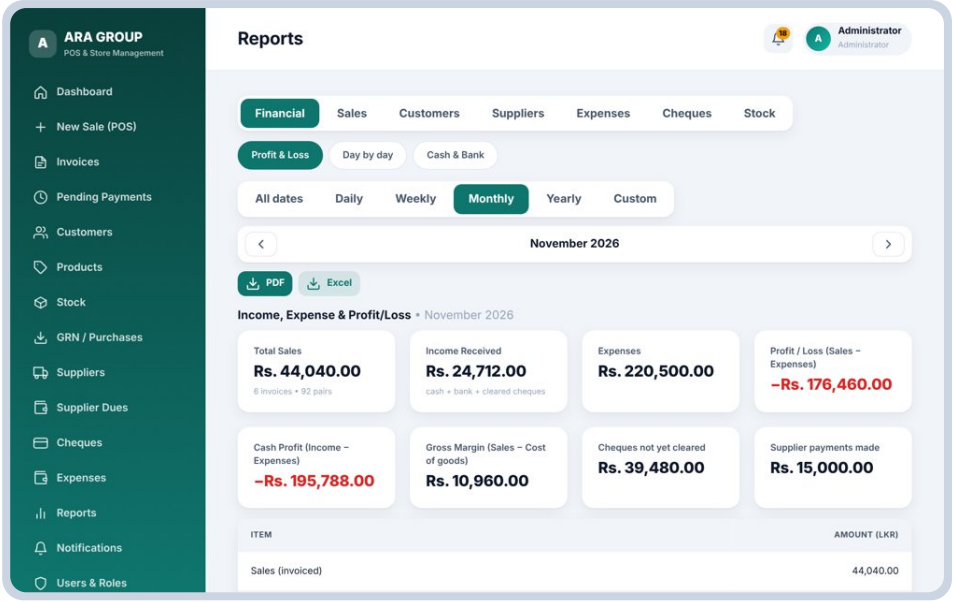
1. Choose a group (Financial, Sales, Customers, Suppliers, Expenses, Cheques, Stock) and then a report.
2. Use the Filters bar for that report and choose Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly, Custom or All dates. The arrows move to the previous or next period.
3. Click PDF or Excel to download exactly what you see.

Reports available

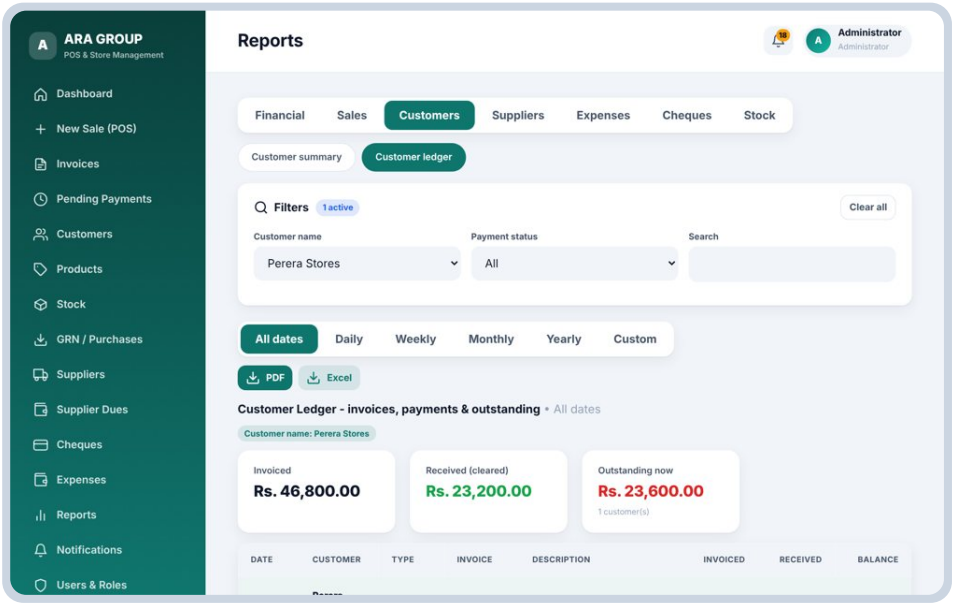
- Financial: Profit & Loss, Day by day, Cash & Bank.
- Sales: Sales / Invoices, Product sales (by ART NO., colour, size).
- Customers: Customer summary, Customer ledger (invoices, payments and outstanding), Customer deposits, Deposit balances and Deposit ledger.
- Suppliers: Supplier summary and Supplier ledger (purchases, payments, cheques and balance owed).
- Expenses: Expenses, Salaries (per employee) and Materials / Purchases (per item).
- Cheques: Customer cheques and Supplier cheques.
- Stock: Stock (opening, in, out and closing for the period) and Stock movement history.

How profit is calculated

- Profit / Loss = Sales - Expenses for the period.
- Cash Profit = Income actually received (cash, bank, cleared cheques) - Expenses.
- Gross Margin = Sales - cost price of the goods sold.



Profit & Loss report



Customer ledger filtered by customer

21. Filters, Date Ranges & Exports

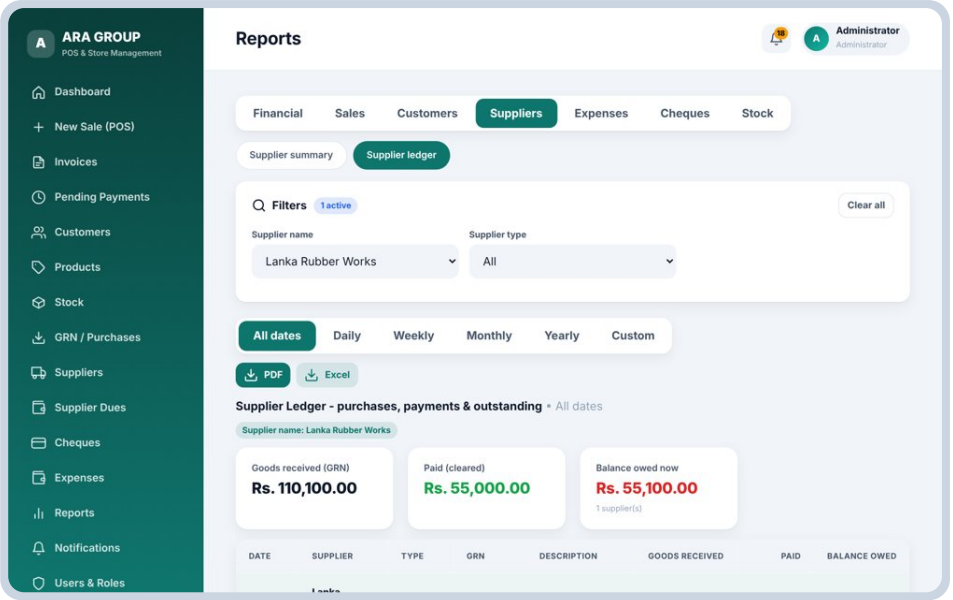
The same filter system is used in Reports, Expenses, Cheques and Stock, so once you know it you can find anything quickly.

How filters work

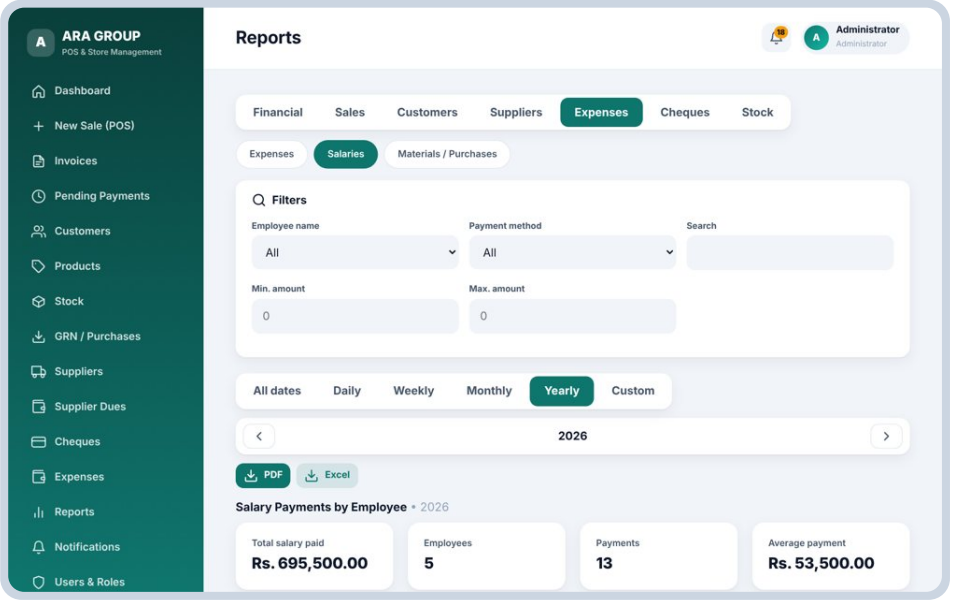
- Open the Filters bar at the top of the page (on a phone, click it). The number of active filters is shown on it.
- Choose as many filters as you want - they all work together, for example Supplier + Item + Payment method + Monthly.
- Text filters such as ART NO., cheque number and search apply as you type. Clear all removes every filter.
- Date ranges: All dates, Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly or Custom (from - to). Use the arrows to go to the previous or next period.
- PDF and Excel buttons export exactly what is on the screen; the filters and dates are printed on the file.

Where to find what

I want to see	Where to look
Salary paid to one employee	Expenses > Category: Salaries > Employee name
Spending on rexine, glue, boxes, PU soles	Expenses > Category: Materials > Item
Everything for one supplier	Reports > Suppliers > Supplier ledger
A customer's invoices, payments and balance	Reports > Customers > Customer ledger
Cheques of one customer or supplier	Cheques (separate tabs) - filter by name
Stock of one ART NO., size or location	Stock > Stock levels > filters
Complete movement history	Stock > Movement history



Supplier ledger



Salary report by employee

22. Notifications

The bell icon shows how many new alerts you have.

You are alerted about

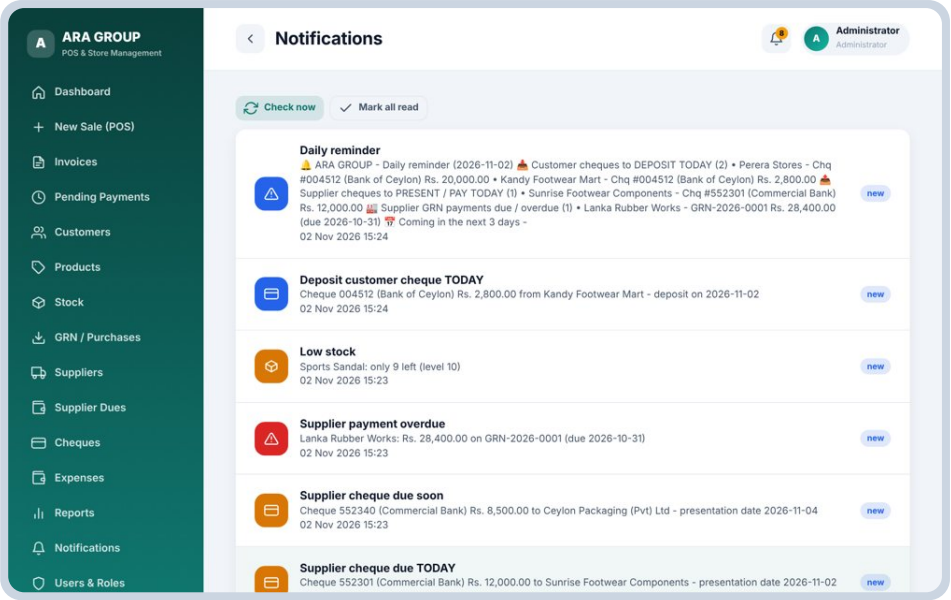
- Customer cheques due for deposit, deposit overdue, deposited but not cleared, and bounced.
- Supplier cheques due soon, due today and overdue.
- Customer invoices that are overdue.
- Products that are low or out of stock.

Daily WhatsApp reminder

Every morning (default 8:00) the system WhatsApps you the cheques that need attention TODAY: customer cheques to deposit, supplier cheques to present or pay, supplier GRN payments due, overdue items and what is coming in the next few days. Set the time and numbers in Settings > Alerts. Use Preview to see today's message and Send it now to test.

Using them

- Click a notification to mark it read and jump to the related screen.
- Check now scans immediately; Mark all read clears the badge.
- Optional: forward alerts to WhatsApp / email (Settings > Alerts).



Notifications

23. Users, Roles & Permissions

Every employee has their own login so you know who created or changed each record. Only people with the right permission see these screens.

Create a user

1. Users > + User.
2. Enter name, username, password (6+ characters), email, phone and choose a Role.
3. Click Save. The employee can sign in straight away.

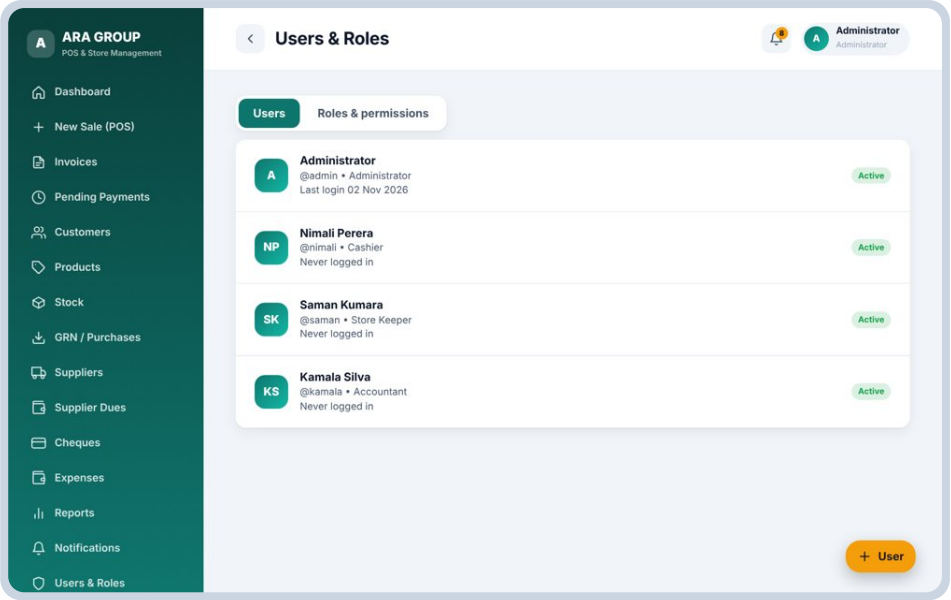
Deactivate or delete

Open the user and untick "Account active" to block login but keep history. Delete works only for users with no activity.

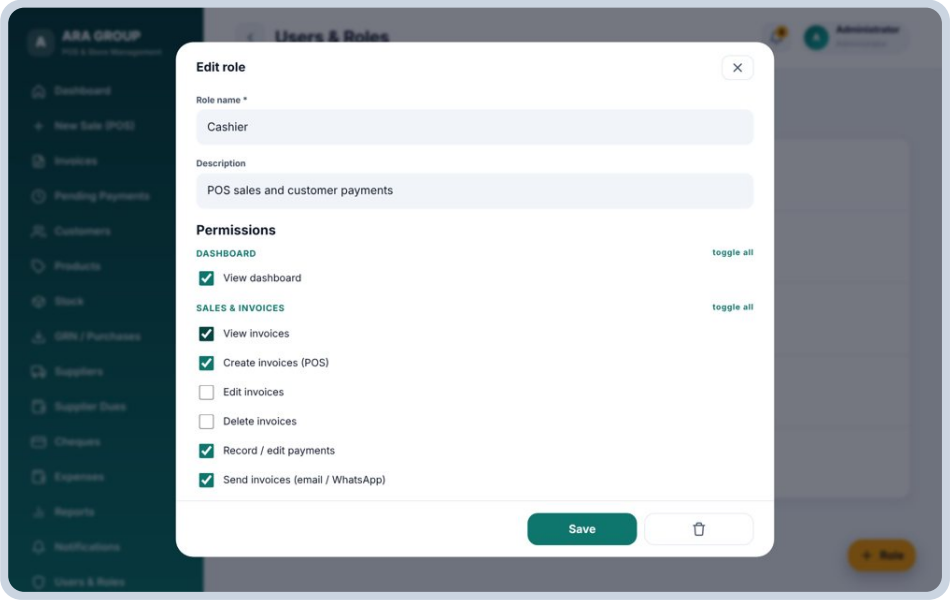
Roles

1. Users > Roles tab > + Role (or open an existing one).
2. Name the role and tick exactly what it may do: view / create / edit / delete invoices, record payments, send invoices, manage customers, products, stock, suppliers, cheques, expenses, reports, users, settings, backups and the activity log.
3. Use "toggle all" to tick a whole group. Save.

> Ready-made roles: Administrator (everything), Manager, Cashier, Store Keeper, Accountant. Change them or make your own.



Users



Role permissions

24. Settings: Company & WhatsApp

Settings (administrators). Click Save settings on each tab after changing it.

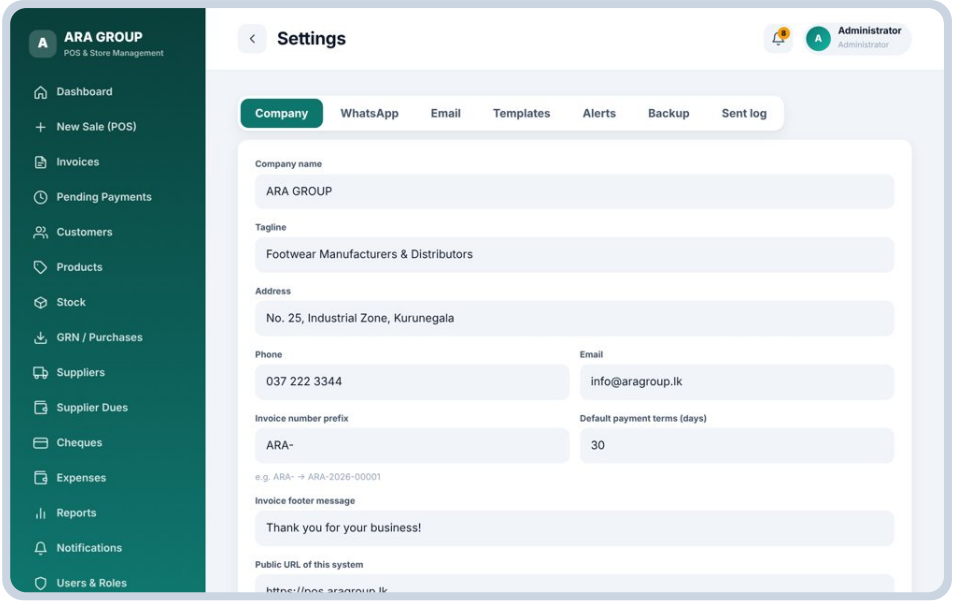
Company

- Name, tagline, address, phone, email: these appear on every PDF invoice.
- Invoice prefix (ARA- gives ARA-2026-00001), payment terms in days and the invoice footer message.
- Public URL: your website address, used in WhatsApp / email invoice links.
- Default country code 94: a number typed as 0771234567 is sent as 94771234567.
- Allow negative stock: lets cashiers sell when the system shows 0.

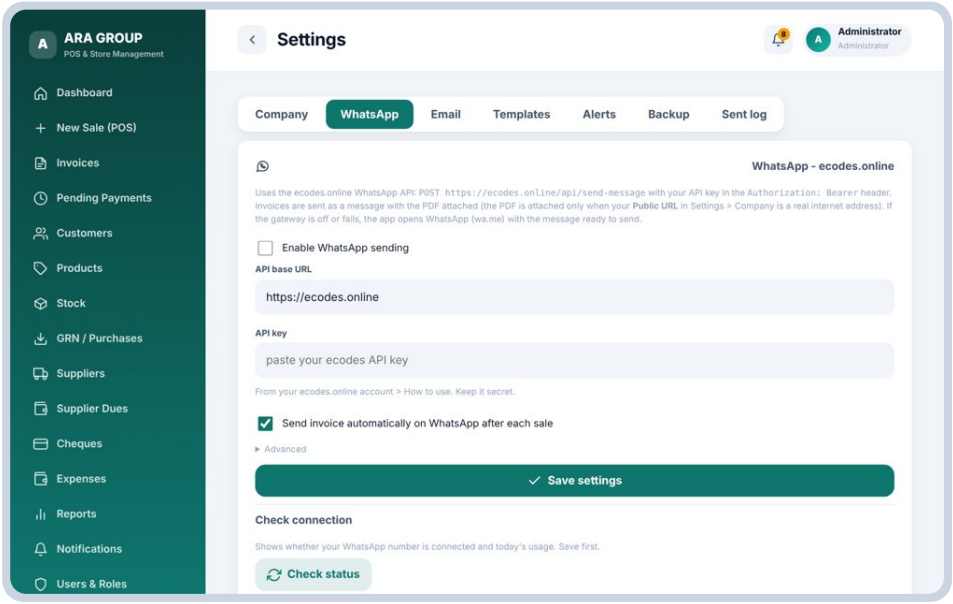
WhatsApp (ecodes.online)

1. Settings > WhatsApp. Tick Enable WhatsApp gateway.
2. Paste your ecodes.online API key (from your ecodes account, How to use page). The API URL is already https://ecodes.online.
3. Click Save settings, then Check status: it shows whether your WhatsApp number is connected and today's usage. If it says not connected, scan the QR code again in your ecodes account.
4. Type your own number and click Send test.
5. Tick "Send invoice automatically on WhatsApp" if you want every invoice sent. The PDF is attached when the Public URL in Company settings is your real website address.

> If the gateway is off or fails, every WhatsApp button opens WhatsApp itself with the message ready, so you can always send manually.



Company settings



WhatsApp settings

25. Settings: Email, Templates, Alerts, Backup

Email (SMTP)

Enter host, port, username, password and the From address. Gmail: host smtp.gmail.com, port 587, and use an App Password. Click Send test. Invoices are then emailed with the PDF attached.

Templates

Edit the wording of every message: invoice, payment received, overdue reminder, statement, bounced cheque and admin alerts. Click a placeholder chip (such as {{customer}} or {{balance}}) to insert it. Use *text* for bold on WhatsApp. You can add custom templates and choose them when sending an invoice.

Alerts

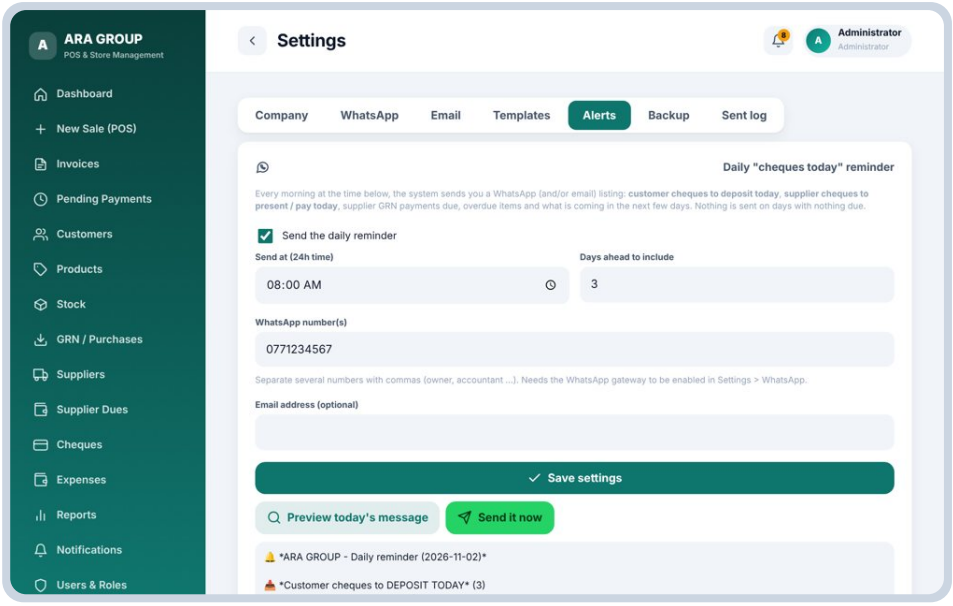
- Daily "cheques today" reminder: tick it, set the time (for example 08:00) and the WhatsApp number(s) of the people who should receive it. Use Preview and Send it now to test.
- Days before a cheque date to include in the reminder.
- Forward new alerts instantly to your WhatsApp and / or email.
- Automatically WhatsApp customers when an invoice becomes overdue.

Backup

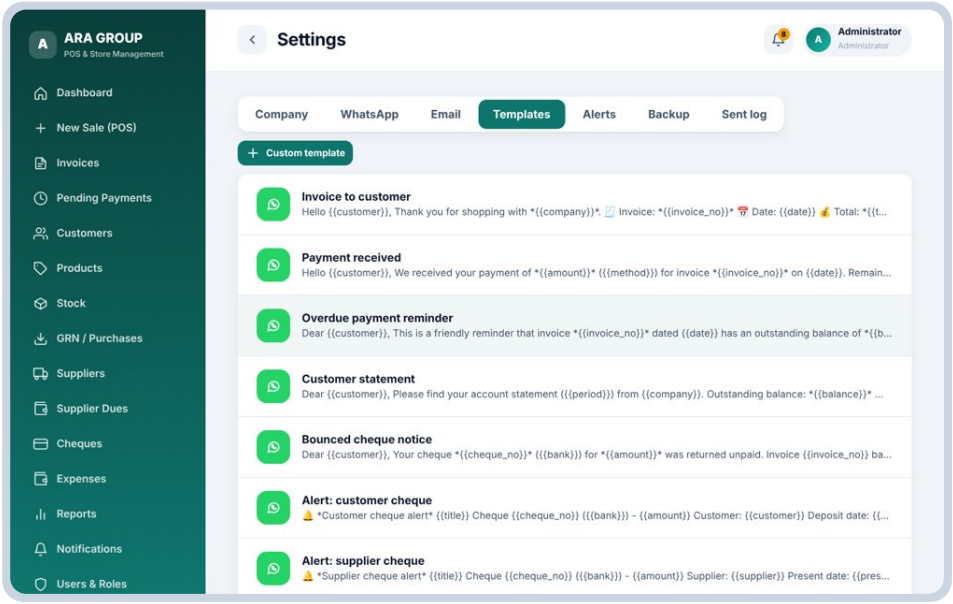
- A backup of the whole database is made automatically every night at 2:00 AM.
- Click Create backup now at any time, and click a backup file to download it. Keep a copy off-site regularly.

Sent log

Shows every WhatsApp and email sent by the system with its status (Sent, Failed, or Manual link).



Daily reminder settings



Message templates

26. Daily Routine & Good Practice

Opening

- Check the Dashboard and Notifications: cheques to deposit, overdue customers, low stock.
- Receive any deliveries with a GRN before selling, and check Supplier Dues for payments due.

During the day

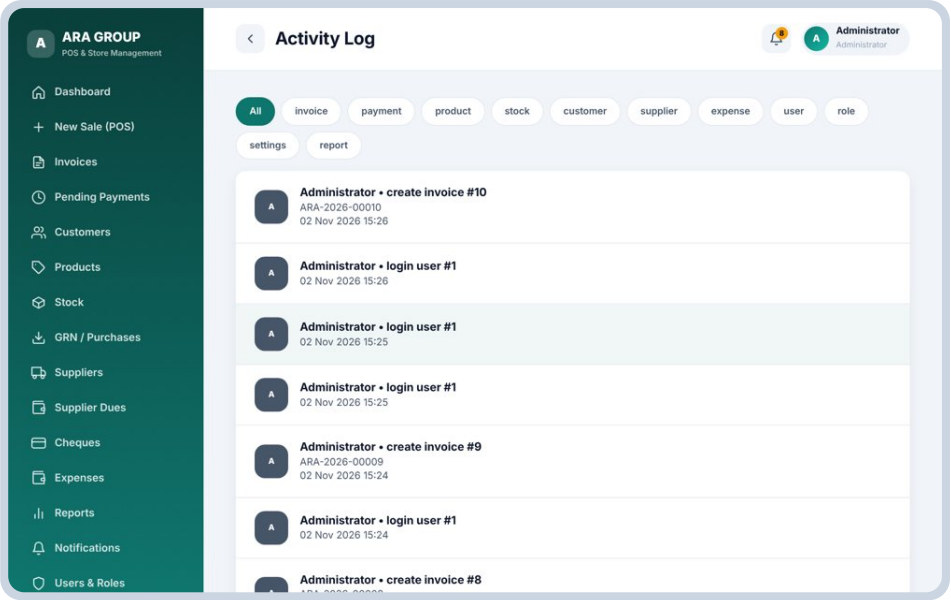
- Every sale through New Sale - never sell without an invoice.
- Record each customer payment on its invoice at the time it is received.
- Record expenses when they are paid and keep the receipt photo.

Closing

- Deposit cheques and update their status (Deposited, then Cleared when confirmed by the bank).
- Open Reports > Day by day to see the day's sales, income and expenses.
- Do stock counts regularly: use Adjust with a reason for any difference.

Security

- One login per person. Never share passwords; change the default admin password.
- Give each person only the permissions they need.
- Review the Activity Log (Activity Log) to see who did what.
- Deactivate accounts of people who leave.



Activity log

27. Questions & Answers

Frequently asked

- I made a mistake on an invoice. Open it and click Edit (needs the edit permission). Stock and totals are fixed automatically.
- The customer paid by cheque - is it counted as paid? Not until you mark the cheque Cleared.
- A cheque bounced. Mark it Bounced on the Cheques screen; the balance returns to the invoice.
- WhatsApp did not send. Check Settings > WhatsApp and the Sent log. Use the WhatsApp button to open and send manually.
- Email says SMTP is not configured. Fill in Settings > Email.
- I cannot see a menu. Your role does not include it - ask the administrator.
- I forgot my password. An administrator can set a new one in Users.
- Can I use it on my phone and the shop computer at the same time? Yes. All devices share one database.
- How do I restore a backup? Ask your hosting / IT person to import the downloaded .sql file into the MySQL database.

28. Quick Reference

Roles at a glance

- Administrator: everything.
- Manager: all business screens, but not users, roles, settings or backups.
- Cashier: POS, payments, customers, invoice sending.
- Store Keeper: products, stock, goods received.
- Accountant: payments, cheques, suppliers, expenses, reports.

Payment status	Meaning
Unpaid	No payment received
Pending	Sold on credit - balance outstanding
Partially Paid	Part of the amount is received (cleared)
Cheque Pending	A cheque is held but not yet cleared
Paid	Fully settled with cleared money
Cheque: Received	In your hand
Cheque: Deposited	Taken to the bank
Cheque: Cleared	Money confirmed in the account
Cheque: Bounced	Returned unpaid - balance restored
Deposit: Cleared / Pending / Bounced	Cleared = available for invoices; Pending (cheque not cleared) and Bounced are not available
GRN: Unpaid / Partially Paid / Cheque Pending / Paid	Same meaning as invoices, but for money we owe a supplier
Supplier cheque: Issued / Presented / Cleared / Returned	Given to supplier / sent to bank / paid / returned